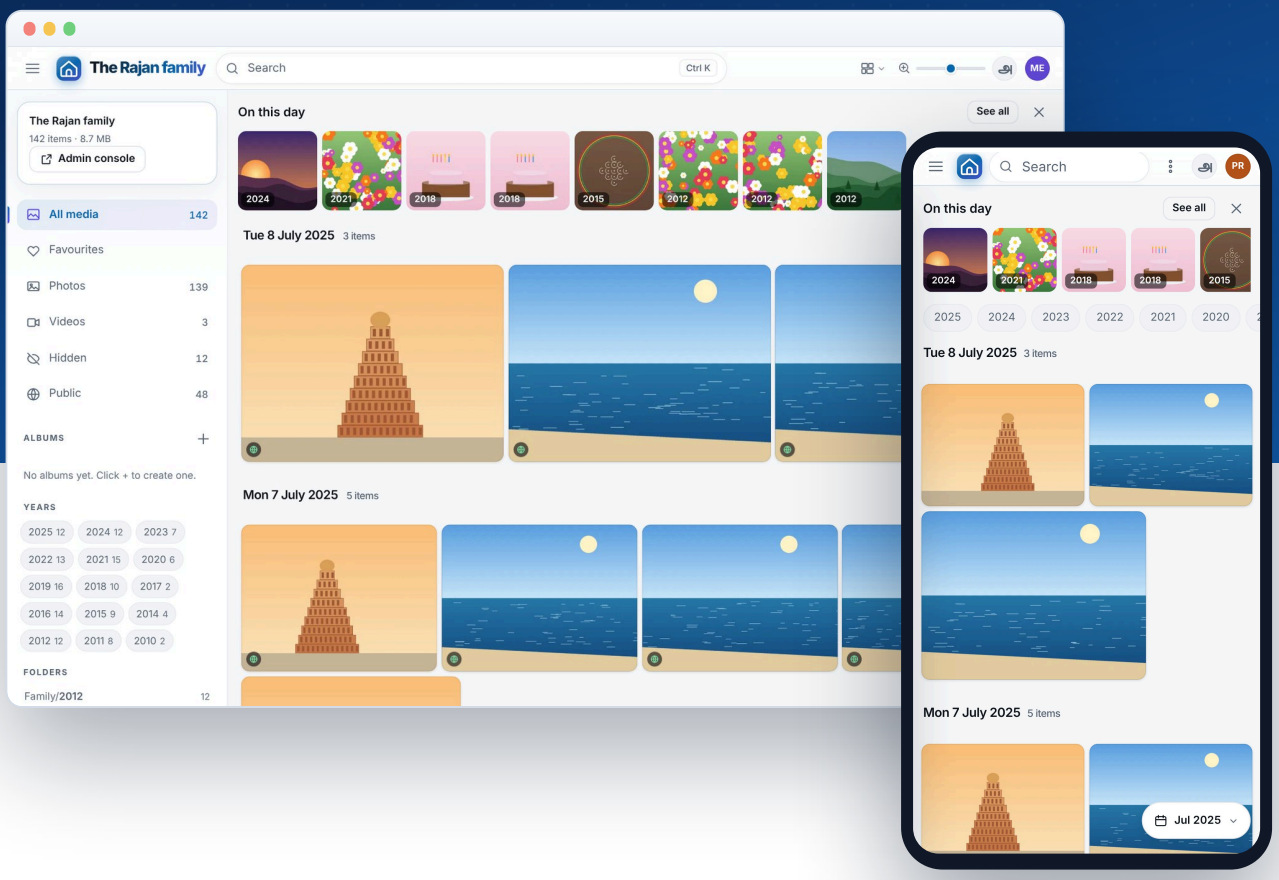
Ninaivu Lite

USER GUIDE

Ninaivu Lite

நினைவு லைட்

Your family's photographs, at home. On every phone, tablet and computer in the house, and nowhere else.



Complete user guide

Version 1.15.0 · 13 October 2026 · with screenshots

Private
Runs on one computer at home. Nothing leaves the house.

Tamil and English
Every screen, message and this guide, in both.

Any computer
Windows 10 and 11, Mac, Linux and Raspberry Pi.

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Version	1.15.0, released 13 October 2026
Screenshots	Taken from this version in English, with a sample library of 129 drawn pictures (one of them a Live Photo) and 3 short videos
Repository	github.com/javajaga-usa/Ninaivu-lite
In Tamil	The same guide is available in Tamil.

01 CHAPTER 1 Before you start

Ninaivu Lite shows your family's photos and videos to everyone at home, on any phone, tablet or computer on the same Wi-Fi. It runs on one computer in the house. It **only reads** your photo folders: it never moves, edits or deletes a photograph, and nothing leaves the house. (The importer copies photos *into* the library from old drives, and Sudar can save an edited *copy* beside an original; neither changes a photograph you have.)

What you need

- A computer that stays on at home: Windows 10 or 11, a Mac, a Linux PC, or a Raspberry Pi 4 or 5 (64-bit).
- Your photos in one or more folders on that computer, or on a drive plugged into it.
- Phones, tablets or computers on the same Wi-Fi, with a current browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox, or Safari 16.4 or newer).

Install it

The simplest way is a download from the Releases page of github.com/javajaga-usa/Ninaivu-lite. Each one carries everything it needs, including its own Python.

Computer	File to download	What to do
Windows 10 / 11	`Ninaivu-Lite-<version>-windows-x64.exe`	Double-click it and follow the steps. The Control Panel opens when it finishes.
Windows, without installing	`Ninaivu-Lite-<version>-windows-x64-portable.zip`	Right-click it, *Properties*, tick *Unblock*, then *Extract All* to a folder that stays put (or a pendrive). Open the `Ninaivu Lite` folder it makes and double-click `Ninaivu Lite.exe`, the Control Panel. Everything stays in that folder, and its top holds only `Ninaivu Lite.exe` and its log, `Ninaivu Lite.log`: the program is in the `app` folder, and the family's settings, people and index go in the `data` folder that appears beside it the first time. To upgrade, press **Stop**, untick **Start Ninaivu Lite when I sign in** and close the old copy's Control Panel, extract the new version to a new folder, copy the old `data` folder into it, and tick the box in the new copy's Control Panel.
Mac	the `.dmg` for Apple silicon (arm64) or Intel (x86_64)	Open it and drag Ninaivu Lite to Applications.
Linux PC	`Ninaivu-Lite-<version>-linux-amd64.sh`	Run `sh` on the file in a terminal. Run as yourself, everything stays in your account and it starts with the computer. Run with `sudo` (a server, or a

		computer the whole house uses), it runs as its own `ninaivu-lite` account: see *Linux, installed with sudo* in chapter 12.
Raspberry Pi	`Ninaivu-Lite-<version>-linux-arm64.sh`	As for a Linux PC.

TIP

The downloads are not code-signed yet, so Windows may say *Windows protected your PC*: press **More info**, then **Run anyway**. Installing for everyone on the computer asks for administrator permission, and a PC with Smart App Control switched on refuses the installer, and the portable zip's Ninaivu Lite.exe too. Then start Ninaivu Lite from a copy of the source: install Python 3.10 or newer from python.org (tick *Add python.exe to PATH*), unzip the download to a permanent folder such as `C:\Ninaivu-lite`, and double-click `start.cmd` (`./start.sh` on a Mac or Linux). The first start takes a minute or two and needs the internet once; keep that window open while the family uses it.

The Control Panel

The Control Panel is a small window on the computer that runs Ninaivu Lite. It opens after installation, and at any time from the **Ninaivu Lite Control Panel** shortcut (in the portable zip, `Ninaivu Lite.exe`; in a copy of the source, `Start - Ninaivu Lite Control Panel.vbs` or `./start.sh --panel`).

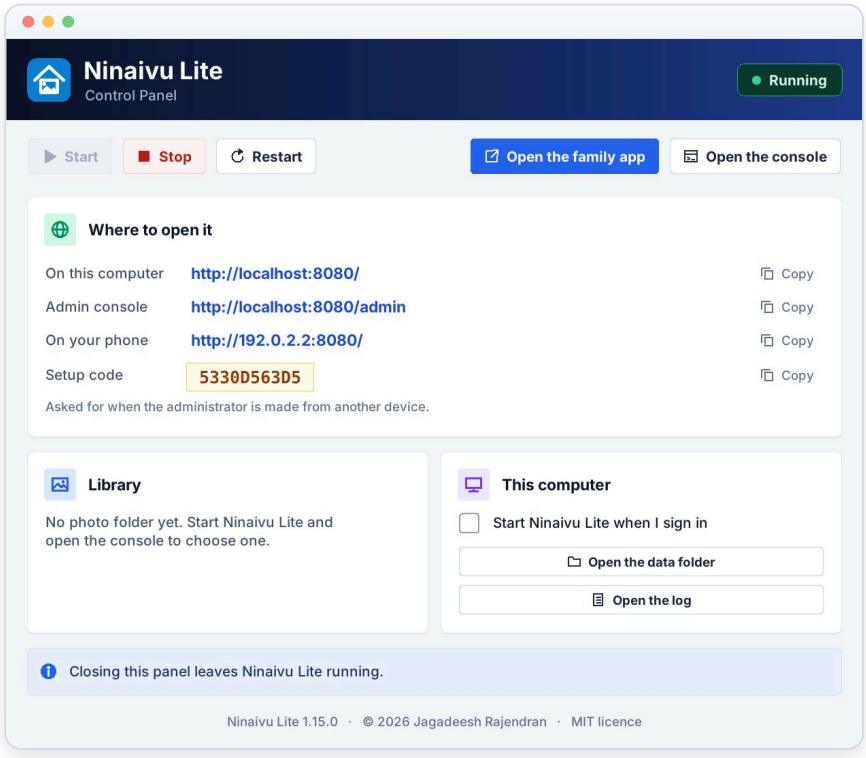


Figure 1 The Control Panel, before the administrator is made: the addresses, and the setup code (its window is in English on every computer).

1. Press **Start**. The status changes to *Running*.
2. Read the addresses under **Where to open it**. Use the *On your phone* address (such as `http://192.168.1.20:8080/`) on phones and tablets.

3. Until the administrator is made, the panel also shows the **Setup code**. It is asked for only when the administrator is made from another device (see chapter 2).
4. Press **Open the family app** for the gallery, or **Open the console** for the administrator's pages.
5. Tick **Start Ninaivu Lite when I sign in** once, so it starts with the computer.
6. Closing the panel leaves Ninaivu Lite running. **Stop** stops it; **Open the log** and **Open the data folder** help when something needs looking into.
7. Ninaivu Lite never looks for updates by itself. Before running a newer setup file, press **Stop** and close the panel. Photos, people, settings and the index are kept.

> **SERVERS**
> on a Raspberry Pi or a server without a screen, the Linux installer sets up a service that starts Ninaivu Lite at boot. Installed with `sudo`, there is no Control Panel: use `sudo systemctl start|stop|restart ninaivu-lite`.

02 CHAPTER 2 The first visit: make the administrator

The administrator decides what everyone else can see. Do this once, on the computer itself if you can.

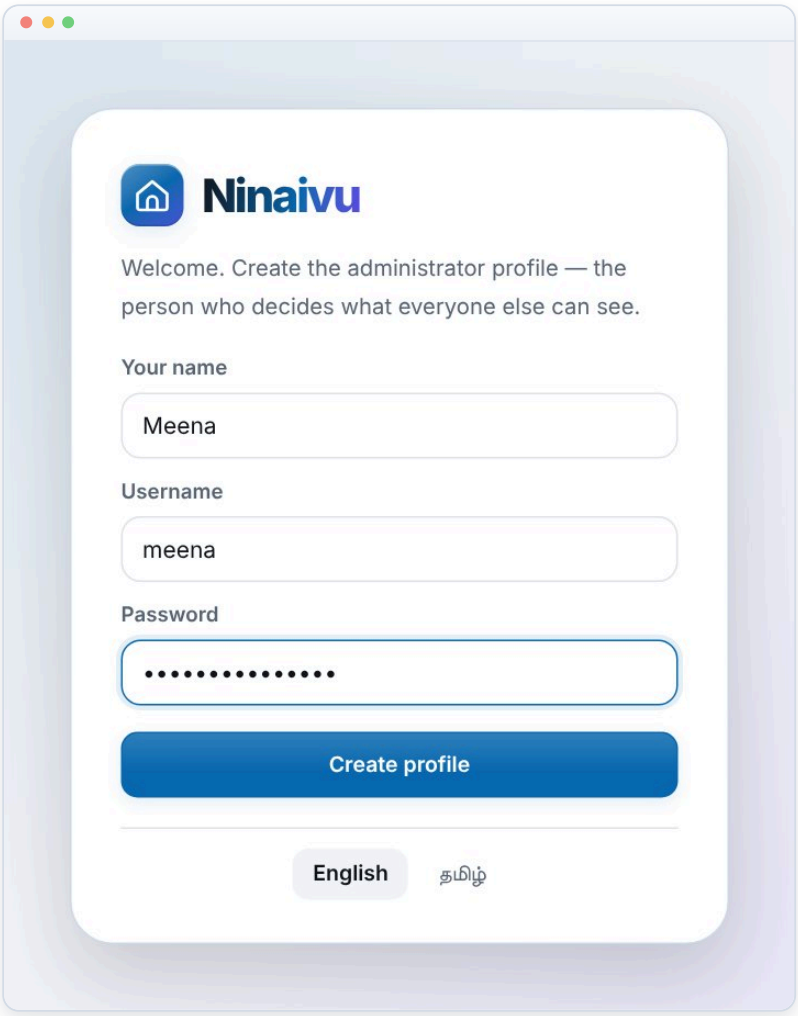


Figure 2 The first page asks for the administrator.

1. Open `http://localhost:8080` (or press **Open the family app** in the Control Panel).
2. Choose the language at the bottom: **English** or **தமிழ்**.
3. Fill in **Your name**, a **Username** (lowercase, no spaces) and a **Password** of at least 8 characters.
4. Press **Create profile**.
5. If you do this from a phone instead of the computer, it also asks for the short **Setup code**. The Control Panel shows it (Figure 1). It is also written to `logs/ninaivu-lite.log` in the data folder (**Open the log**), and printed in the window when Ninaivu Lite was started from a copy of the source. On a Linux service, run `journalctl -u ninaivu-lite | grep code` (with `--user` if it was installed without `sudo`); with Docker, `docker logs ninaivu-lite`.

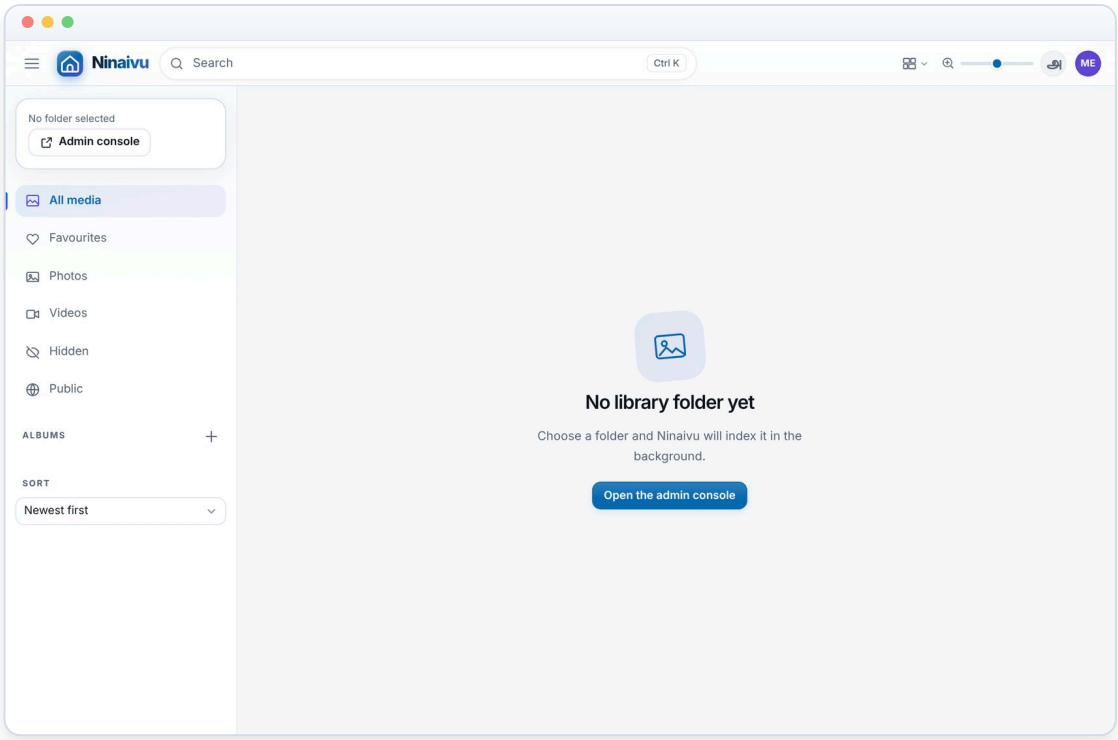


Figure 3 Until a folder is chosen the gallery is empty and points to the console.

Press **Open the admin console**. The console opens with the first-day walk-through.

03 CHAPTER 3 The first-day walk-through

Four short steps: the library folder, old photos to bring in, the household, and what the family can do. **Skip for now** leaves any of them for later.

Step 1: where are the photographs?

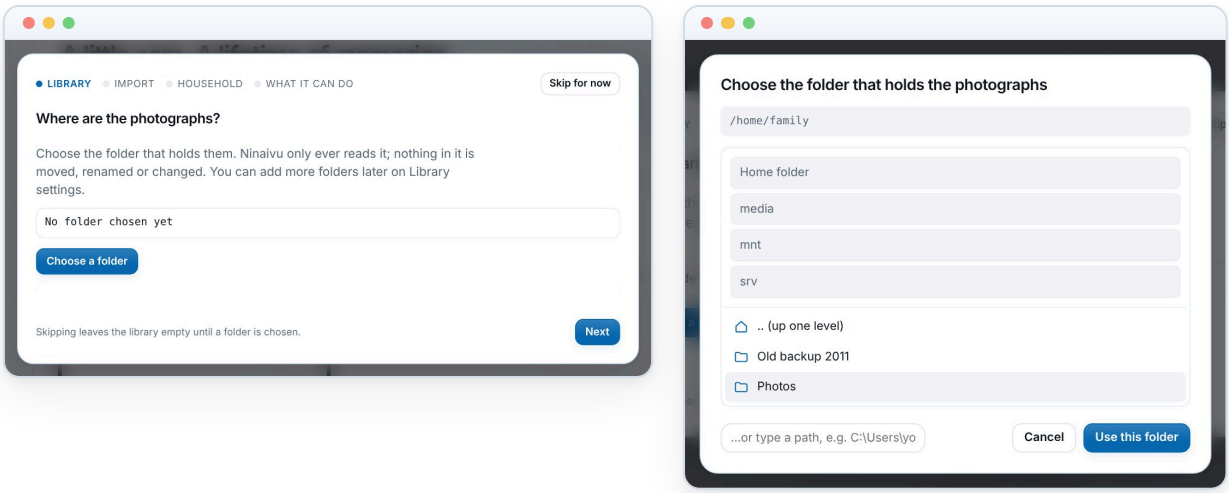


Figure 4 Choose the folder that holds the photos.

1. Press **Choose a folder**.
2. Click through the folders, or type the path in the box at the bottom (for example `D:\Photos`).
3. Press **Use this folder**. Indexing starts at once; photos appear as they are found.
4. Press **Next**.

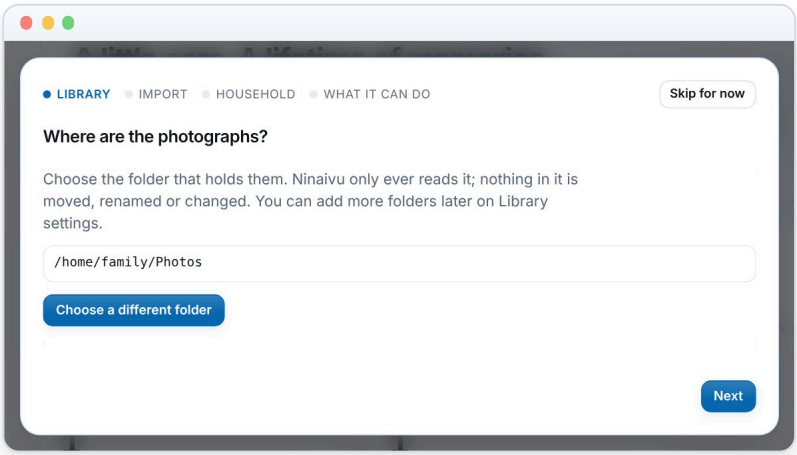


Figure 5 The chosen folder. More can be added later under Library settings.

Step 2: bring in old photos

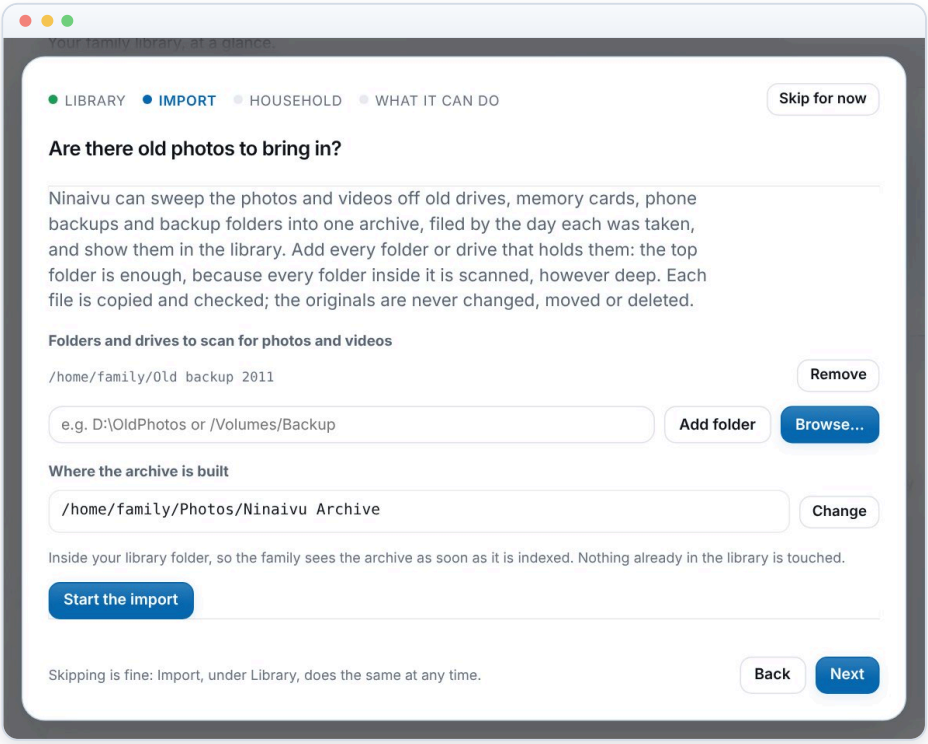


Figure 6 Add old drives, memory cards and backup folders to sweep into one archive, then start the import.

1. Type the top folder of an old drive or card and press **Add folder**, or use **Browse...**. Every folder inside it is scanned, however deep.
2. Check **Where the archive is built**. By default it is inside your library folder, so the family sees the photos as they arrive.
3. Press **Start the import**. Every file is copied and checked; the originals are never changed, moved or deleted.
4. Press **Next**. The import carries on in the background; you can watch it on the **Import** page. If there is nothing to bring in, skip this step: *Import*, under *Library*, does the same at any time.

Step 3: who is in the household?

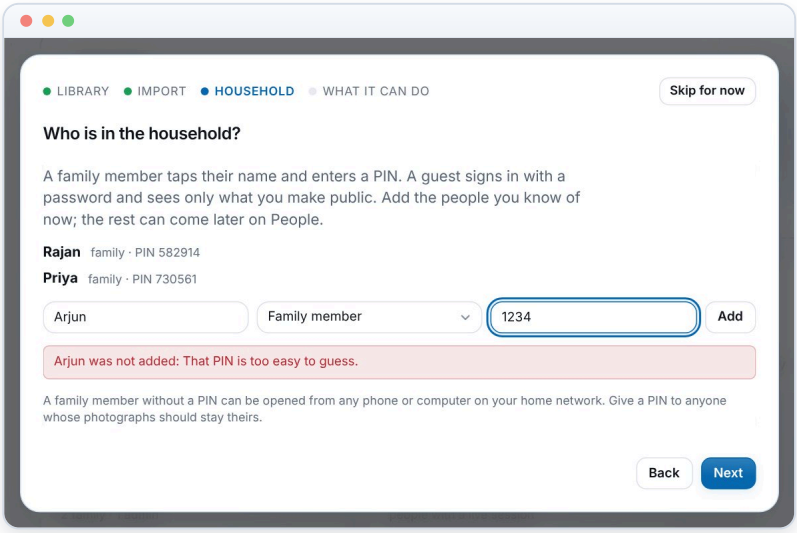


Figure 7 Each person gets a name, a role and, if you like, a PIN.

1. Type a name, choose **Family member** or **Guest**, and type a PIN of 4 to 8 digits (or leave it empty). A guest gets a password instead.
2. Press **Add**. The person appears in the list above. Repeat for everyone.
3. A PIN that is too easy to guess, such as 1234, is refused with a message under the form. Choose another.
4. Press **Next**.

> **TIP**
> A family member without a PIN can be opened from any phone or computer on your home network. Give a PIN to anyone whose photographs should stay theirs.

Step 4: what your family can do

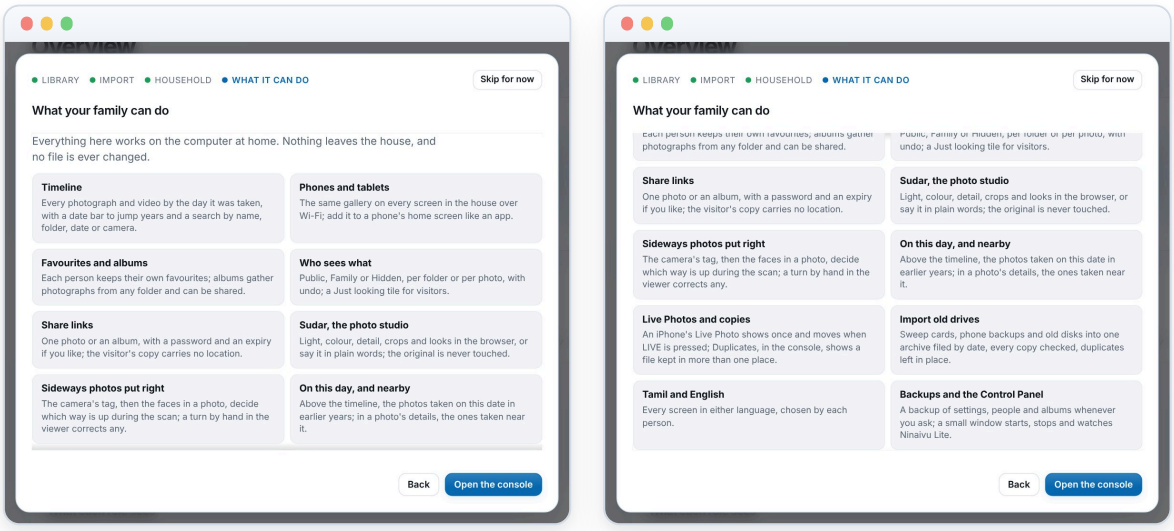


Figure 8 A short tour of what the family can do, and the rest of it further down.

Read it (it scrolls inside the box), then press **Open the console**.

04 CHAPTER 4 The admin console

The console is at `http://<computer>:8080/admin`. Only administrators can open it; it asks for the username and password.

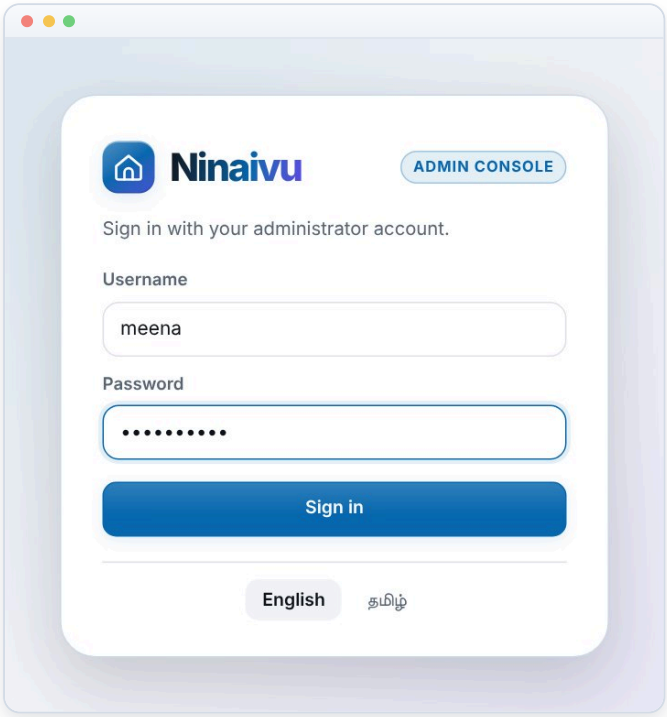


Figure 9 Signing in to the console.

Overview

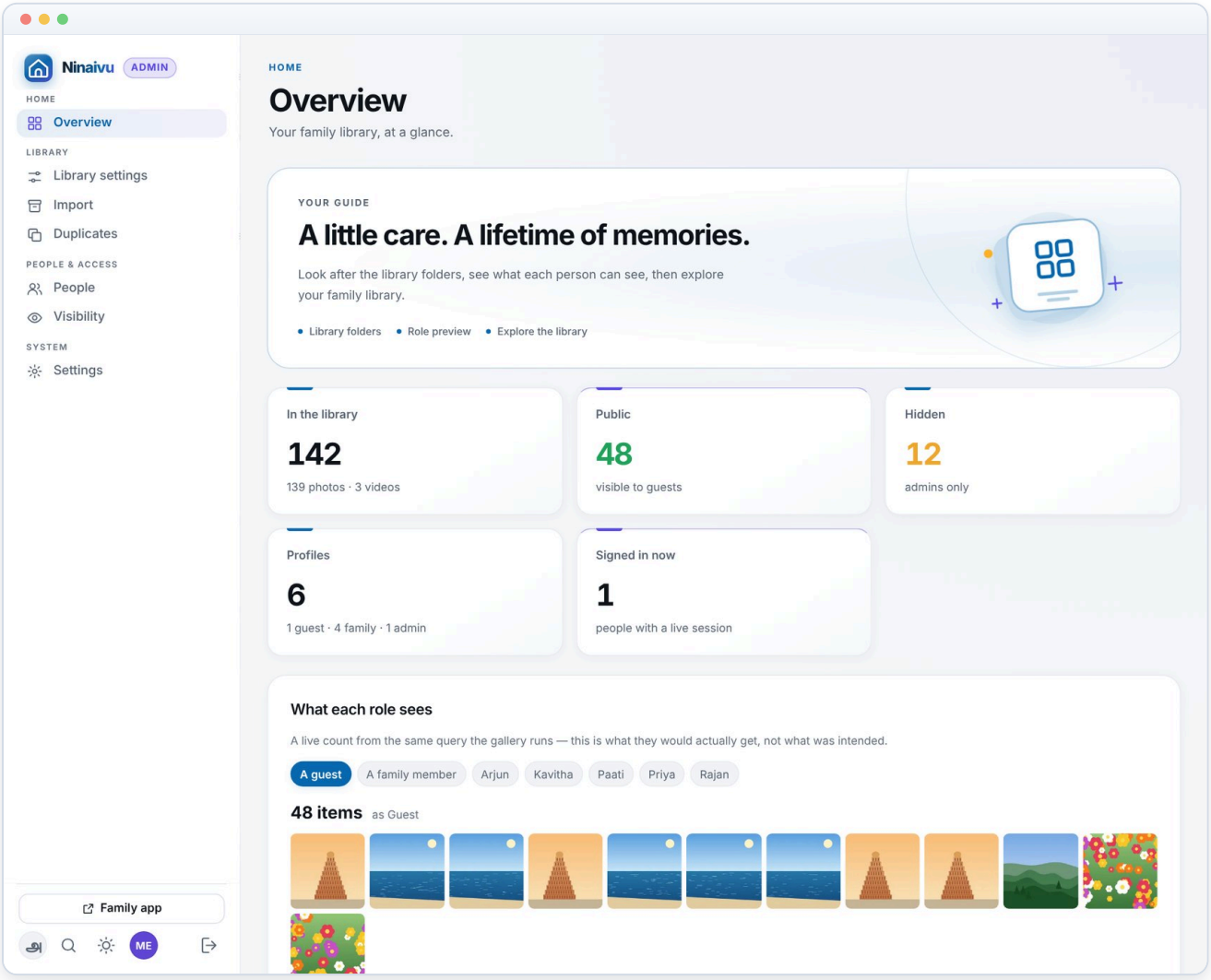


Figure 10 Overview: how many photos, how many are public or hidden, profiles, and who is signed in.

Under **What each role sees**, choose a role or a person to see the library exactly as they would. The library card at the bottom lists the folders and the address for the family app.

Library settings

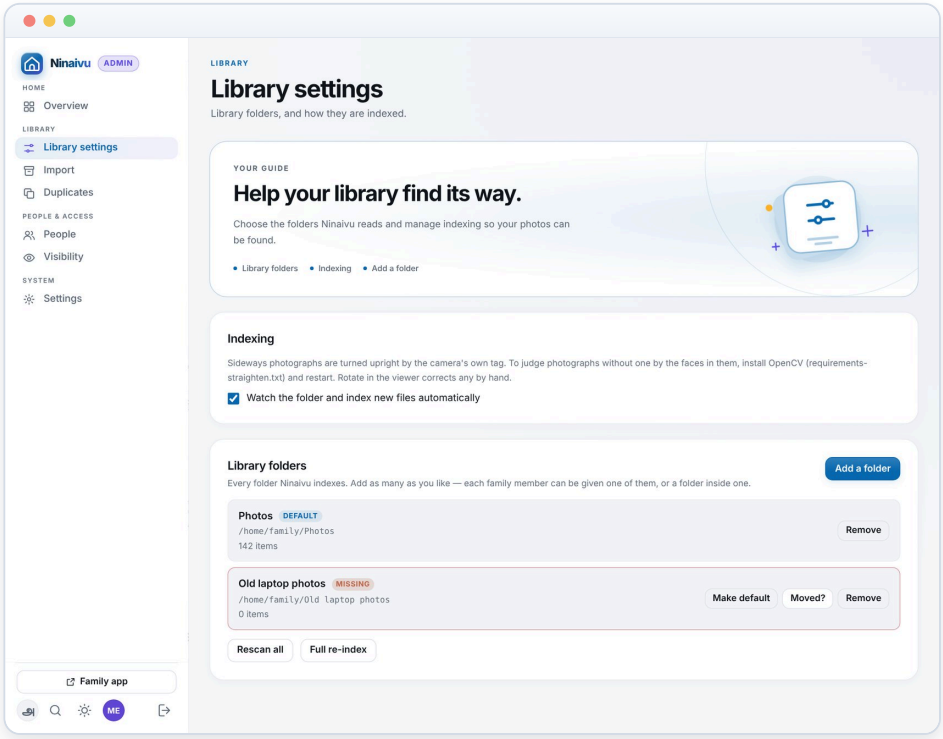


Figure 11 Library settings: the folders Ninaivu Lite reads, and indexing. *Old laptop photos* is not where it was, so it has a Moved? button.

- **Add a folder** adds another photo folder (another drive, for example).
- **Watch the folder and index new files automatically** picks up new photos by itself as they are copied in.
- **Rescan all** looks for changes now; **Full re-index** reads everything again from the start.
- **Remove** takes a folder out of the library, after asking. The photos on disk are not touched, and a copy of the index is taken just before. Who sees what, favourites, albums and share links come back if the same folder is added again.
- **Moved?** (**The photographs are somewhere else now: choose where**) appears beside a folder that cannot be found. If its photos are somewhere else now (a new drive letter, a new computer), press it and choose the new place: the folder points there and keeps everything.

> **TIP**
> The first scan makes a small preview of every photo. A computer with several cores makes them on all of its cores but one (three at a time on a Raspberry Pi, seven on an eight-core laptop) and always leaves one core for the gallery, so the family can look at photos while it works. Later visits to the gallery open at once until something in the library changes.

Import: old drives into one archive

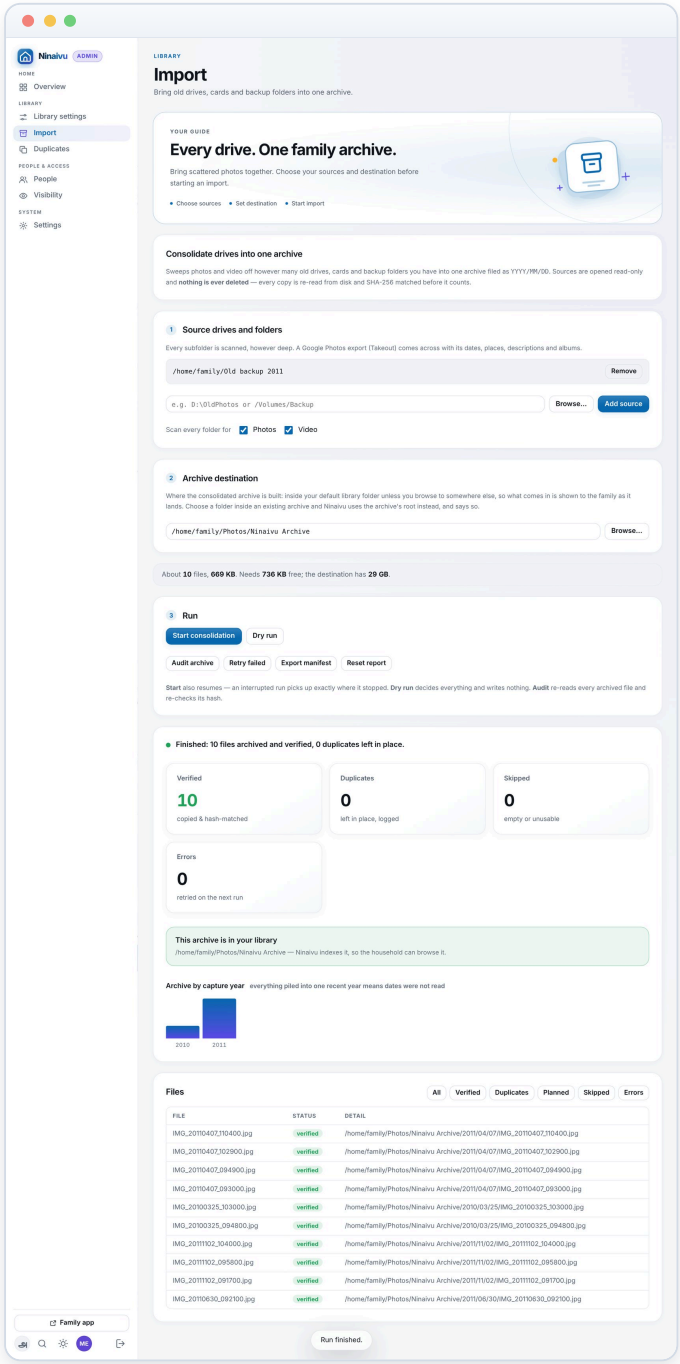


Figure 12 The Import page: sources, destination, run, and the result of each file.

1. **Sources:** add each old drive, card or backup folder with **Add source**. Every folder inside is scanned.
2. **Destination:** where the archive is built, filed as `YYYY/MM/DD` by the day each photo was taken. Choose the archive's own root; pick a folder inside one and Ninaivu uses the root instead, and says so.

3. **Run:** Start consolidation copies and checks every file (hashed as it is read, read back from the archive before it counts). Duplicates are found by content and left where they are; the same name with different bytes gets `_1`. Start also resumes an interrupted run. Dry run decides everything and writes nothing; Audit archive re-reads every archived file and re-checks its hash. Imported photos appear in the gallery while the import runs.
4. When it finishes, Add to library makes the archive part of the gallery (an archive inside the library folder, as here, already is). A Google Photos export (Takeout) comes across with its dates, places and descriptions, and Make the albums recreates its albums once the archive is indexed. Export manifest writes a list of every file with its hash.

> **NOT FINISHED?**
> If the drive is unplugged or the destination fills up part-way, the run ends as not finished and says so. Plug the drive back in (or make room) and press Start consolidation to finish; what was copied is kept.

Duplicates

Duplicates, under Library, lists the photos and videos kept in more than one place in the library, byte for byte: a thumbnail, each copy's folder, size and date, and Open in gallery, under a total such as “3 photos and videos have copies elsewhere, 164.5 KB in the extra copies”. The scan finds them in its quiet pass after the thumbnails. The page only shows: Ninaivu Lite never moves or deletes a file. To tidy up, delete the copies you do not want in the folders themselves; the next scan updates the list.

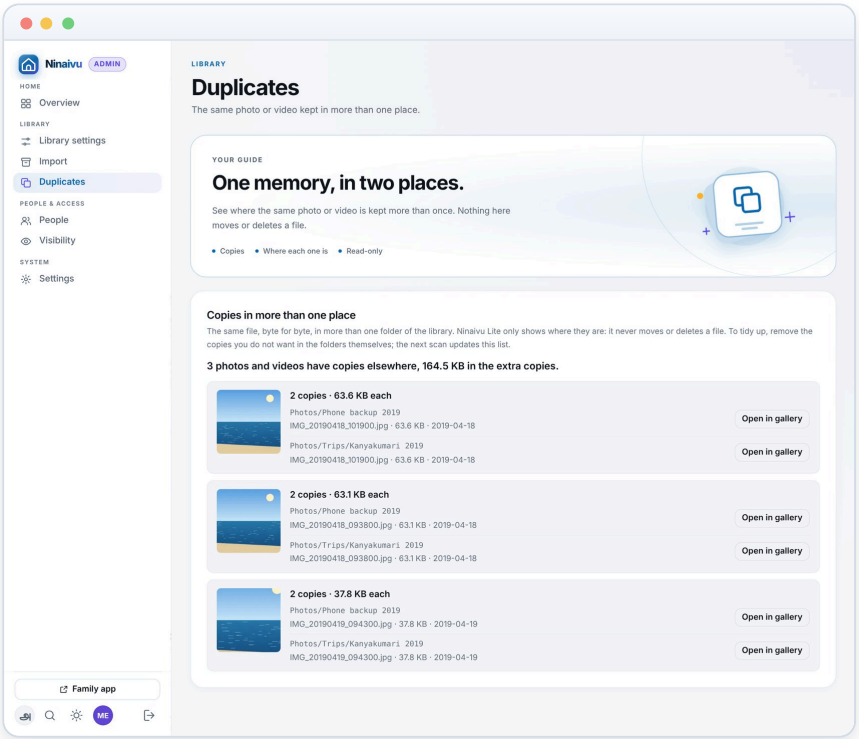


Figure 13 Duplicates: three photos kept again in a phone's backup folder, with where each copy is.

People

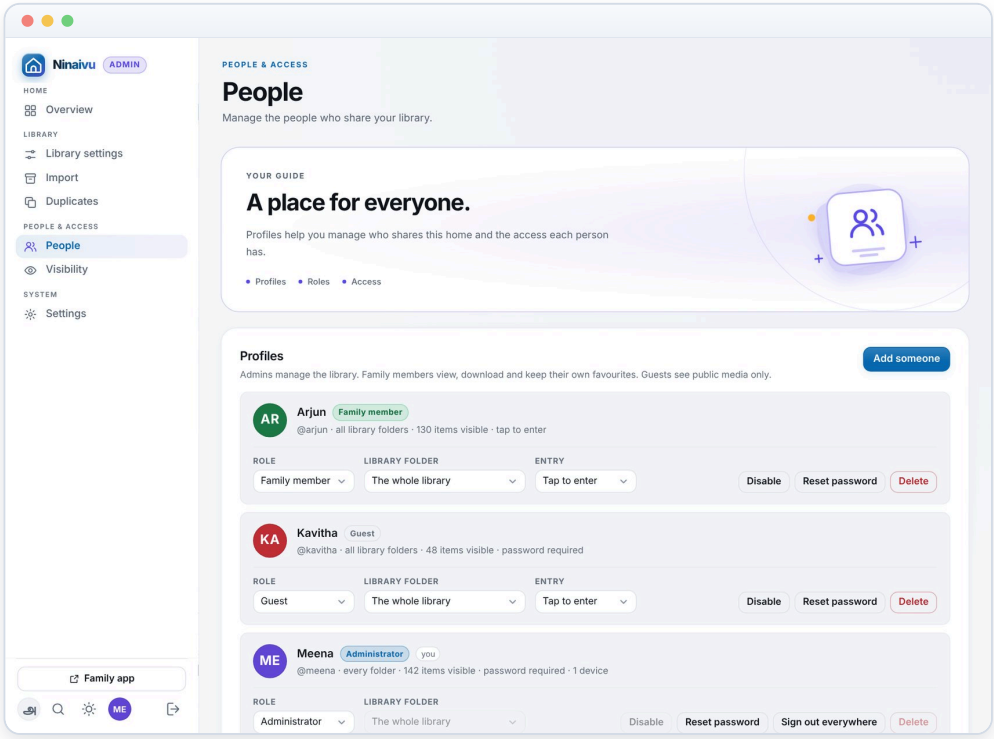


Figure 14 People: everyone who shares the library, with their role, folder and how they sign in.

1. To add someone, press **Add someone**.
2. Fill in the name and username, choose the role and the library folder they may see, and how they sign in: **Tap to enter — no secret**, a PIN, or a password.
3. Press **Create profile**.
4. For anyone already listed you can change the role, folder or entry, **Disable** them, **Reset password**, **Sign out everywhere**, or **Delete** them.

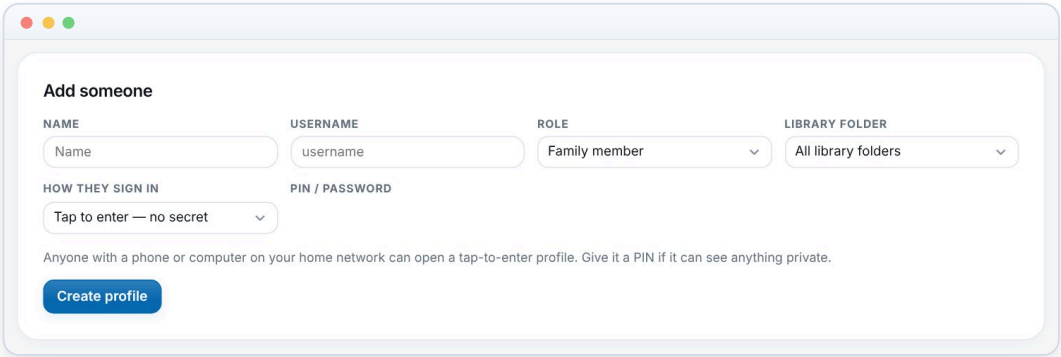


Figure 15 The Add someone form.

Role	Can
Admin	Everything: folders, people, who sees what, settings.
Family member	See Public and Family photos, download, favourites, albums, share links.
Guest	See Public photos only.

You can also give a person **one folder** (for example only `Trips`): they then see nothing outside it.

Visibility: who sees what

Every photo is **Everyone** (public: guests and *Just looking* visitors too), **Family** (the default) or **Nobody** (hidden: administrators only). Set it per folder here; the rule covers everything inside the folder, including photos added later.

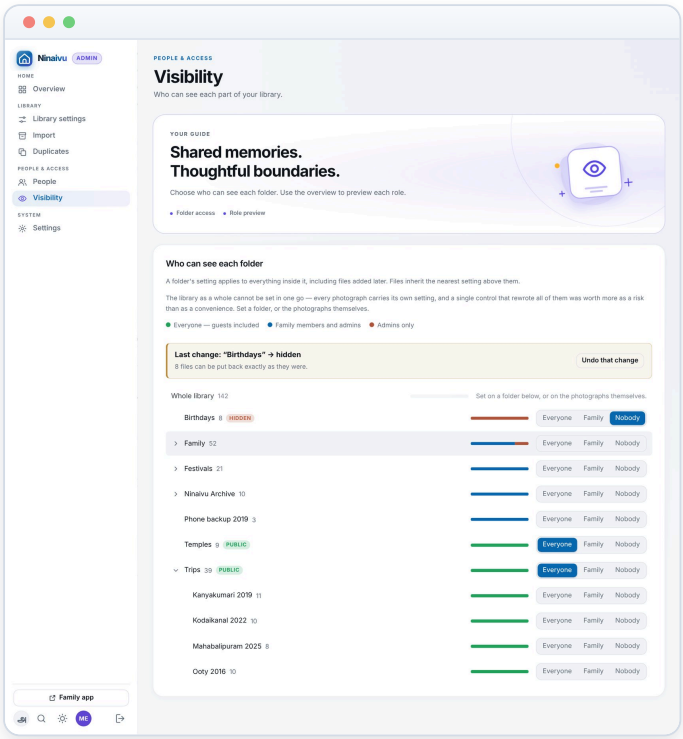


Figure 16 Visibility, folder by folder.

1. Find the folder (press the arrow to open the folders inside it).
2. Press **Everyone**, **Family** or **Nobody** on its row.
3. If this would show photos that are now more private, a box asks first. Press **Show them anyway** to go ahead.
4. A banner shows the last change with **Undo that change**, in case you change your mind.

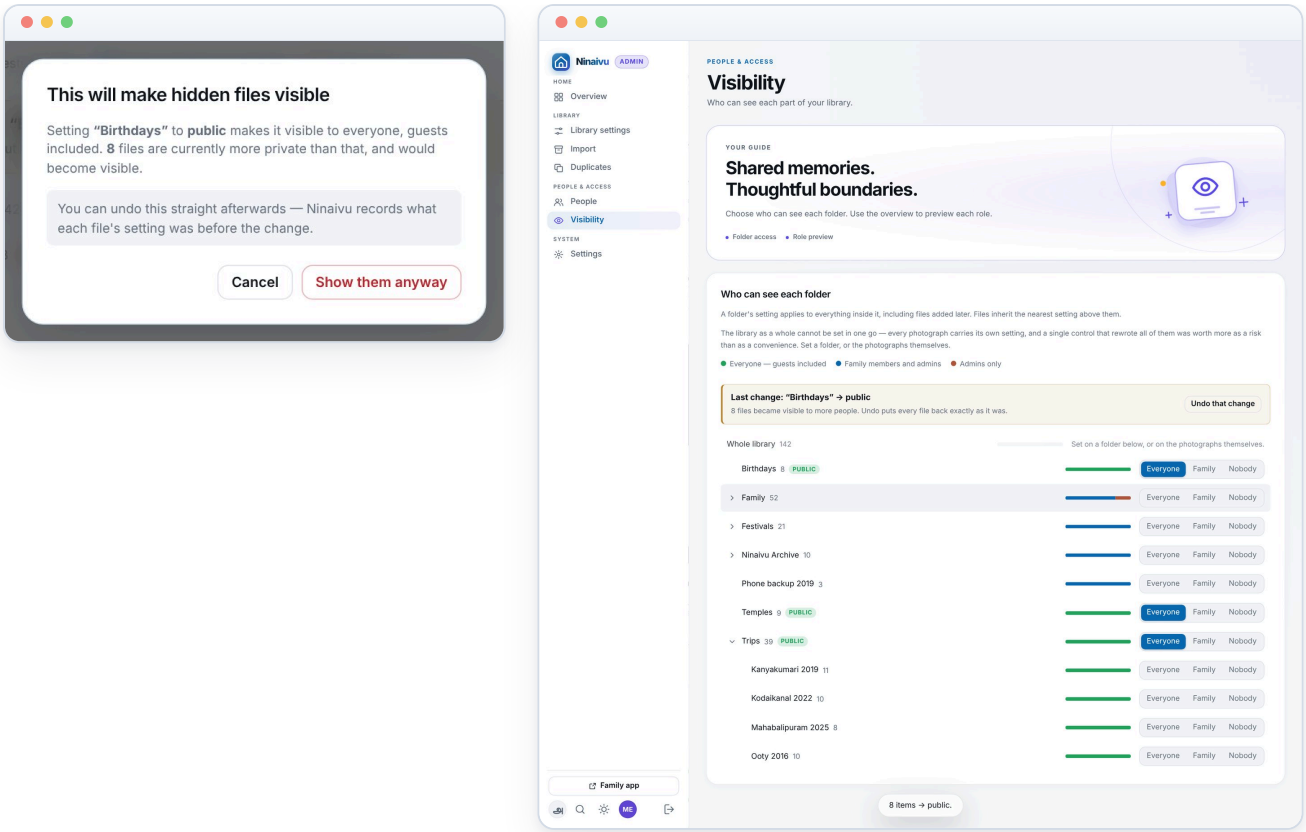


Figure 17 Confirming a change, then the change with its Undo.

> **TIP**
> Administrators can also change one photo while viewing it, with the three buttons in the viewer's bar.

Settings

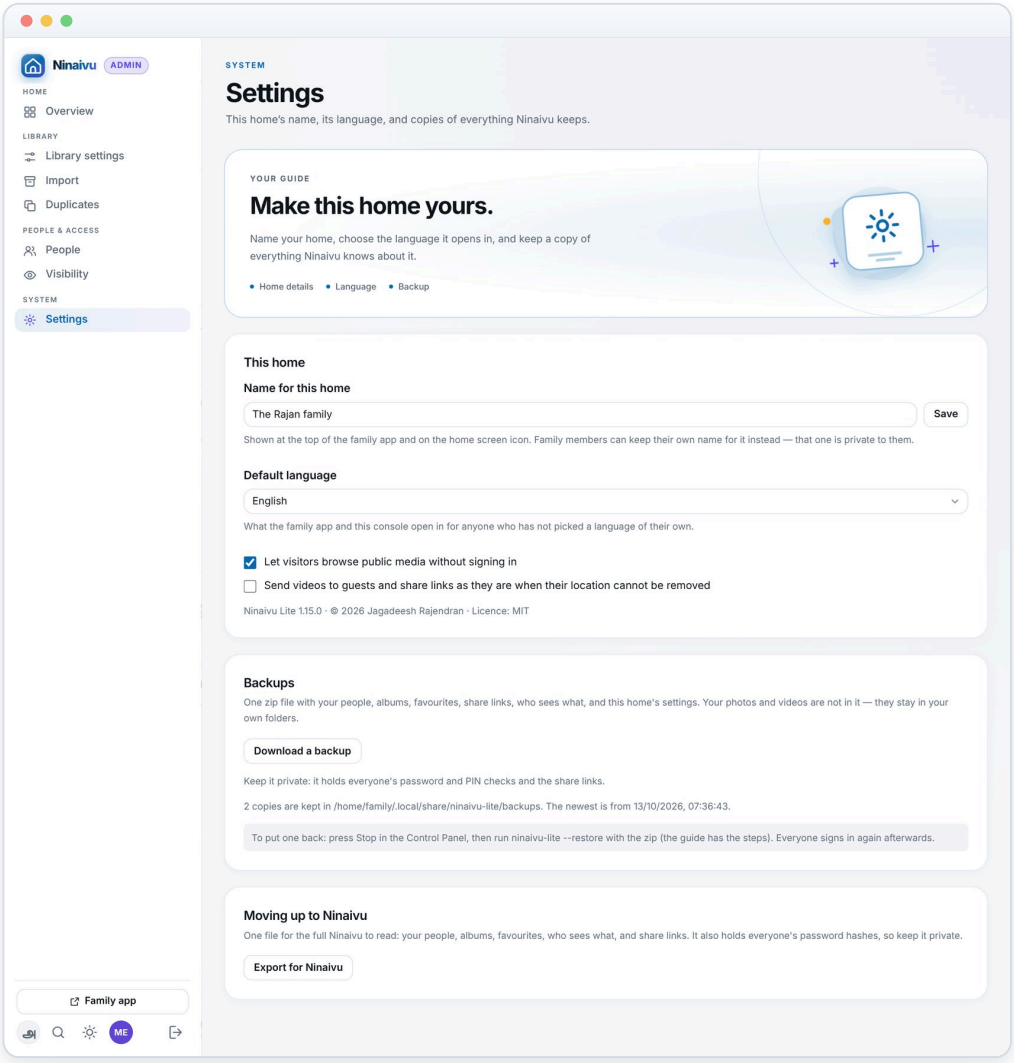


Figure 18 Settings: the home's name, the default language, guest browsing, videos for guests, and backups.

- **This home**: the name shown at the top of the family app, and the default language for new visitors.
- **Let visitors browse public media without signing in**: the *Just looking* tile. Untick it if the library should be private.
- **Send videos to guests and share links as they are when their location cannot be removed**: off by default. A video is sent to a guest or a share link with its location removed, which needs ffmpeg on the computer; without ffmpeg such a video is not shared unless this is ticked (it then keeps its location). See chapter 8.
- **Backups**: Download a backup gives you a full recovery zip to keep somewhere else: the index with people, albums, favourites, share links and who sees what, the settings, and profile pictures. Keep it private: it holds everyone's password and PIN checks and the share links. Ninaivu Lite also makes one by itself every day; Settings lists the copies kept, and says so if the last daily copy failed (chapter 12).
- **Moving up to Ninaivu**: Export for Ninaivu is an optional file, if you ever move the library to the full Ninaivu.

05 CHAPTER 5 Plugging in a pendrive, a drive or a phone

Plug a USB pendrive, a memory card, an external hard drive or a phone (by its cable) into the computer Ninaivu Lite runs on. No box pops up: the drive appears as a notice at the top of the console, on whichever page is open. The Control Panel, if it is open, says so in its own window and points you to the console.

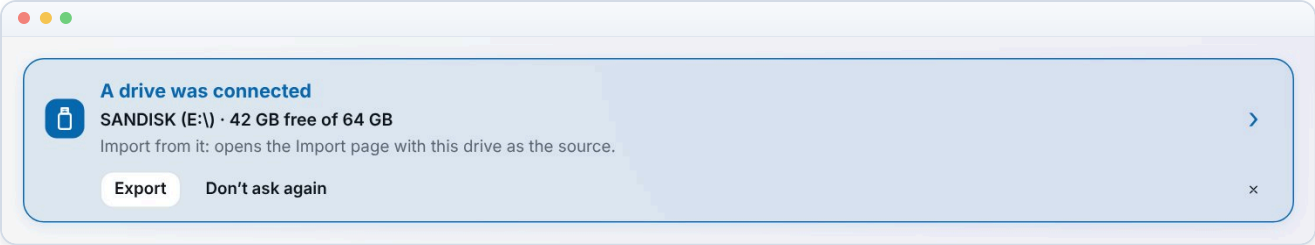


Figure 19 A drive was connected: the notice at the top of the console.

- Click the notice itself to import: the **Import** page opens with the drive as the source. Check the destination and press **Start consolidation**. Nothing on the drive is changed.
- **Export** copies the library's photos and videos onto the drive, into a `Ninaivu Lite` folder, keeping the library's own folders. The notice shows the progress and a **Stop** button. Next time only what is new is copied; nothing already on the drive is overwritten or deleted. When it finishes, eject the drive before unplugging it.
- **Don't ask again** means that drive is never mentioned again, even when it is plugged in another day. To undo it, press **Ask again** under **Plugged-in drives** in **Settings**.
- **×** closes the notice; it comes back when the drive is next plugged in.

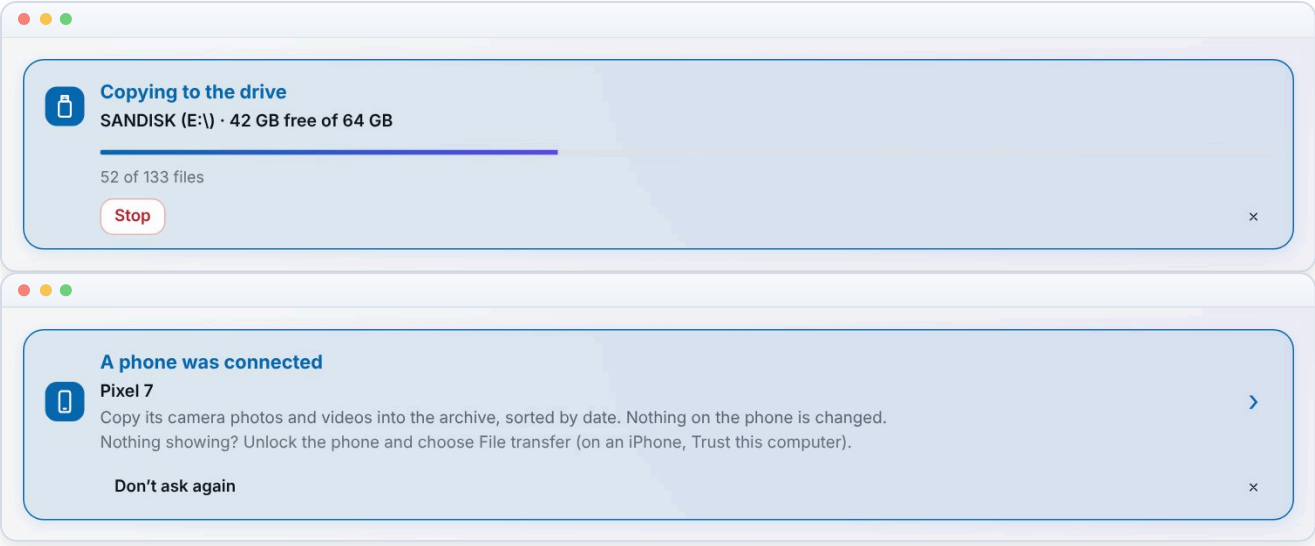


Figure 20 Copying the library to the drive, and a phone on its cable.

A phone has no **Export**: clicking its notice imports from it. Unlock it and choose *File transfer* (Android) or *Trust this computer* (iPhone), or Windows cannot see its photos. On Windows the camera folders (DCIM, Pictures, Movies) are copied across the cable, imported into the archive, and the temporary

copies removed; next time only new photos come across. Nothing on the phone is changed. On Linux, open the phone in the file manager first; on a Mac, phones are not detected.

TIP

The computer's own disks, and a drive the library itself is on, never get a notice. When Ninaivu Lite was installed on Linux with `sudo`, it runs as its own account and may not see drives or phones your desktop opens: add their folders under *Import* yourself.

06 CHAPTER 6 The family gallery on a computer

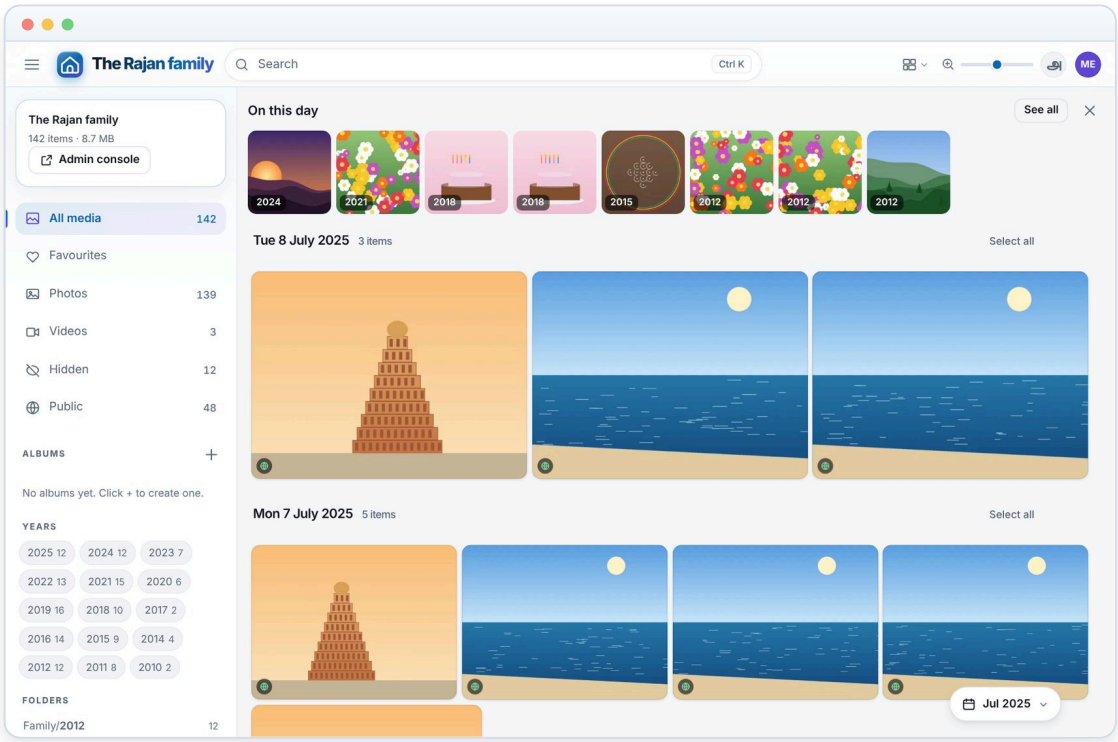


Figure 21 The timeline: newest first, grouped by the day each photo was taken.

- **Left menu: All media**, **Favourites**, **Photos**, **Videos**; for administrators also **Hidden** and **Public**. Below them your albums, a row of years, and the folders with their counts.
- **Top bar:** search, the view menu, the thumbnail-size slider, the language button (அ) and your profile.
- **Date bar:** on the right edge, drag to jump to a month or year.

On this day

Above the timeline, **On this day** is a row of the photos taken on today's date in earlier years, each marked with its year. Click one to open it, or **See all** to show them all in the gallery; × (**Hide until tomorrow**) hides the row until tomorrow on that device. It shows only on the plain timeline (no search, folder, year or album chosen), and only what you may see.

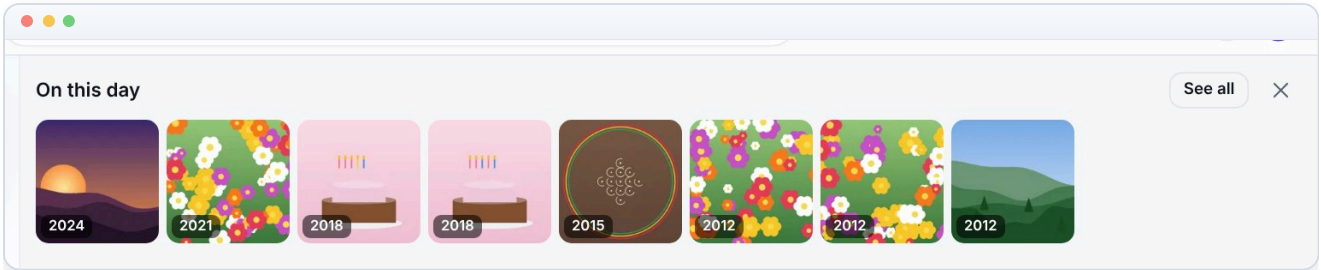


Figure 22 On this day: photos taken on today's date in earlier years, each with its year.

Jump to a year or month

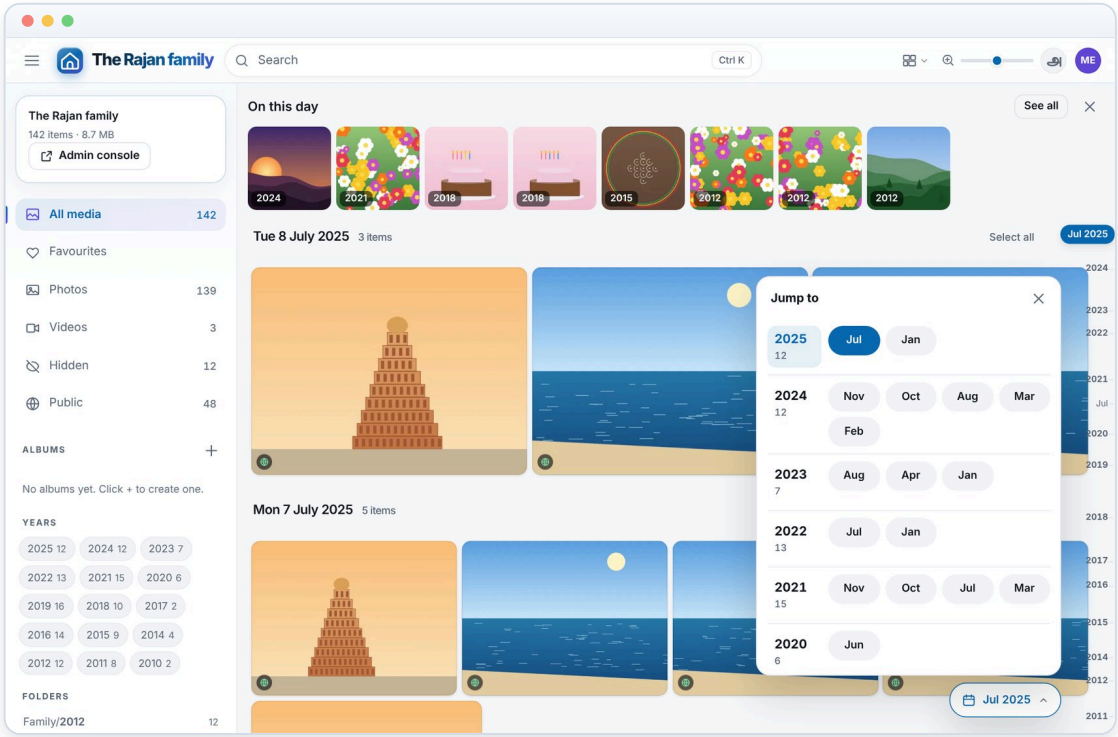


Figure 23 The button in the bottom corner names the month on screen; its list shows only the years and months that have photos.

1. Click the date button in the bottom corner of the photos (it shows the month you are looking at), or press **D**.
2. Click a month to go straight to it, or a year to go to its first month. Only months with photos are listed, with how many each year has; **Undated** is at the end when some photos have no date.
3. With the keyboard, the arrow keys move through the list, Enter goes there and Esc closes it.

The list follows what is on screen: in **Videos**, a folder or a search it lists only the months found there. It is shown for **Newest first** and **Oldest first**, the two orders by date.

Search and folders

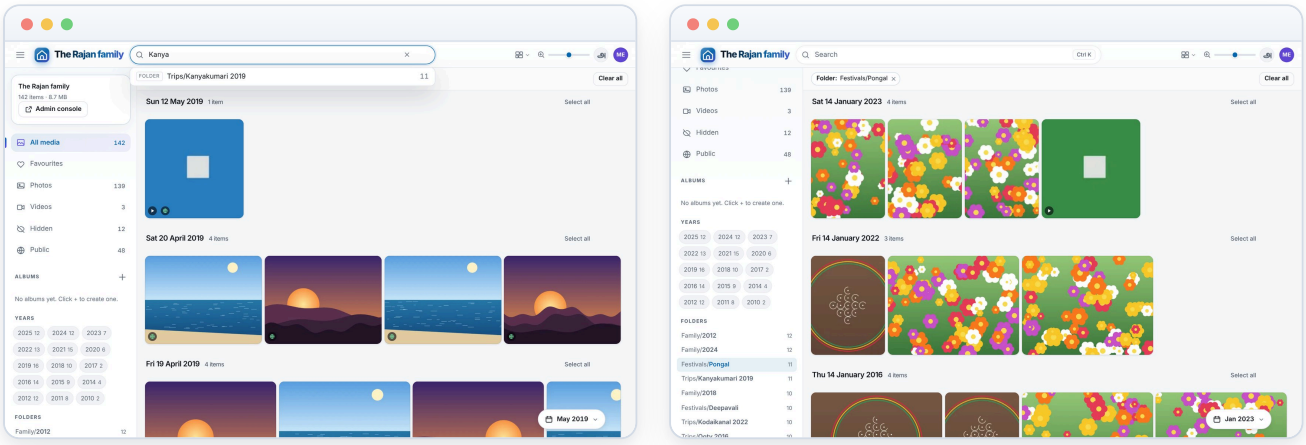


Figure 24 Searching for a place, and one folder opened from the left menu.

1. Type in the search box: a file name, a folder, a year or month, or a camera name. Suggestions appear as you type; press Enter.
2. Or click a folder or a year in the left menu.
3. A chip at the top shows what is filtered. Press × on it, or **Clear all**, to see everything again.

Selecting photos and making an album

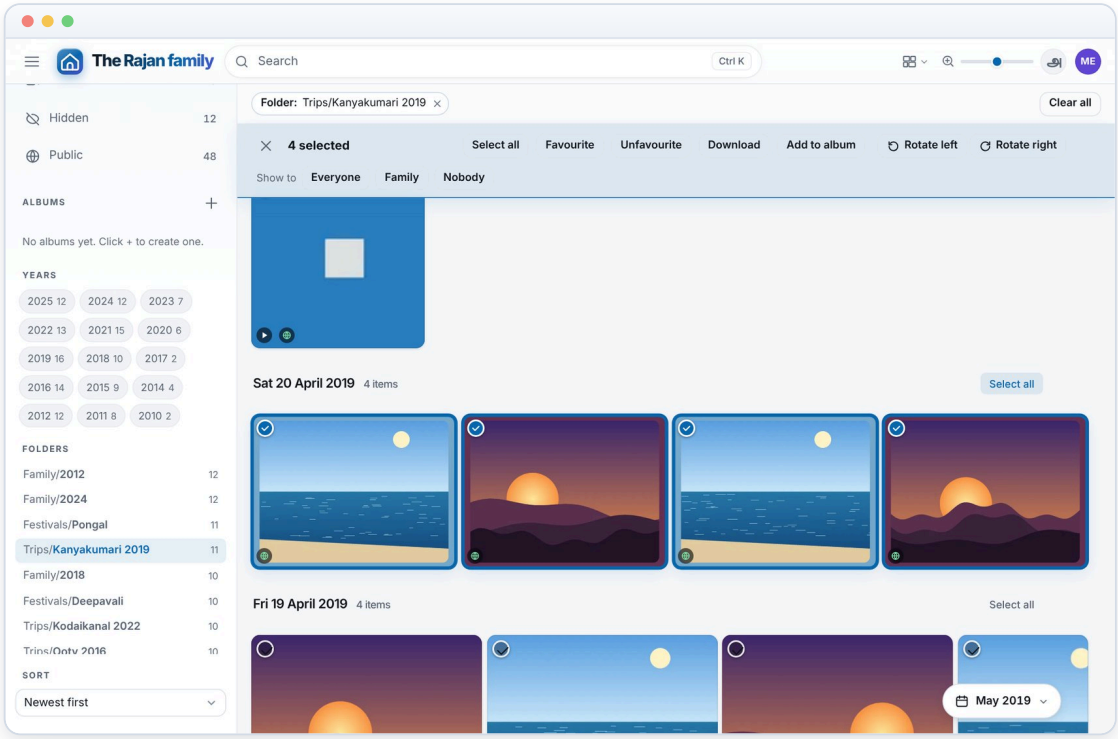


Figure 25 A day selected; the bar at the top acts on the selection.

1. Press **Select all** beside a day, or tick photos one by one.
2. The bar at the top offers **Favourite**, **Download** (as a zip), **Add to album** and, for administrators, **Rotate left** and **Rotate right** (each turned a quarter from the way it is shown, files untouched) and who may see them.
3. Press **Add to album**, type a new album name and press **Create**, or pick an existing album.
4. The album appears under **Albums** in the left menu. Open it to rename, share or delete it.

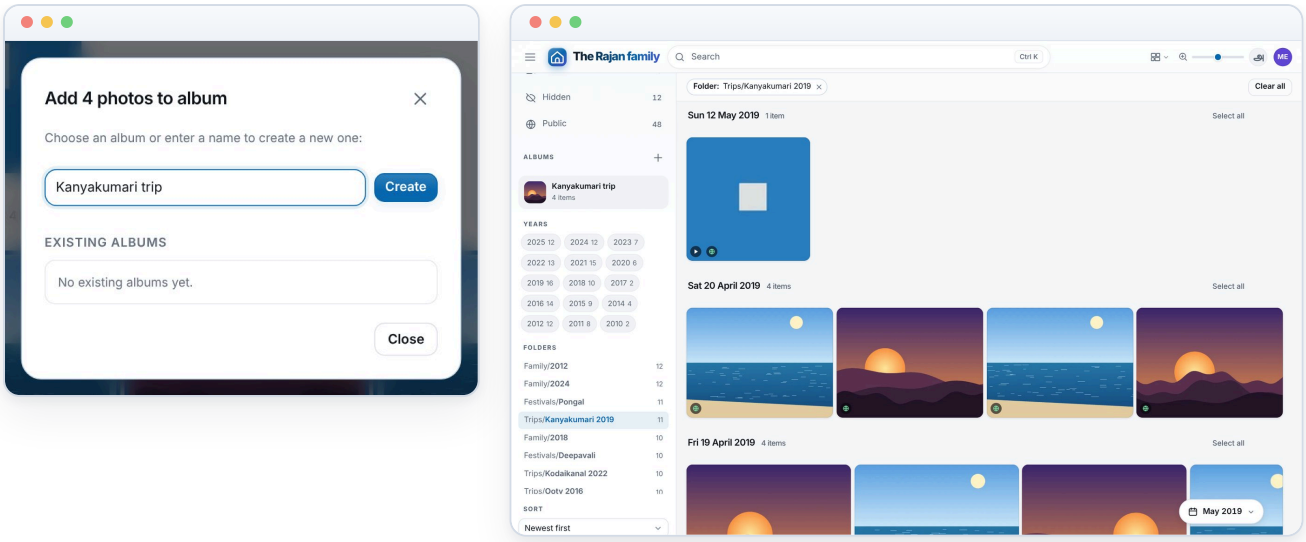


Figure 26 Naming the new album, then the album opened.

Favourites

Each person keeps their own favourites. Press ♡ in the viewer (or **Favourite** on a selection), and find them under **Favourites** in the left menu.

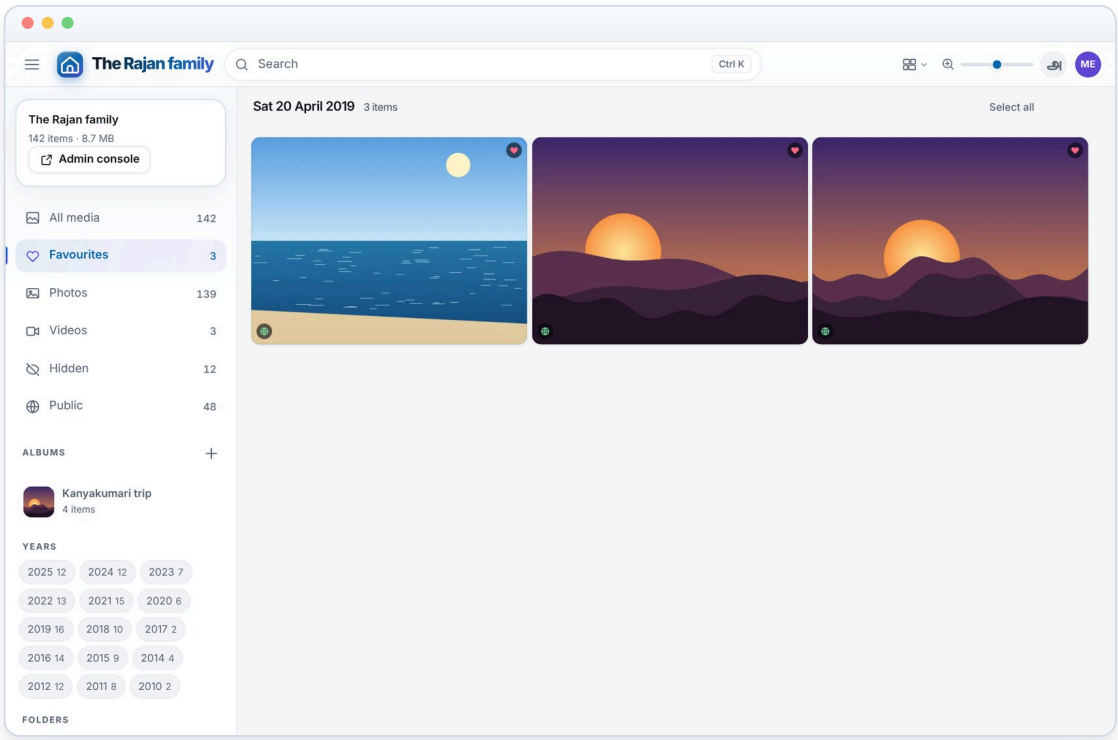


Figure 27 Favourites.

07 CHAPTER 7 Viewing a photo

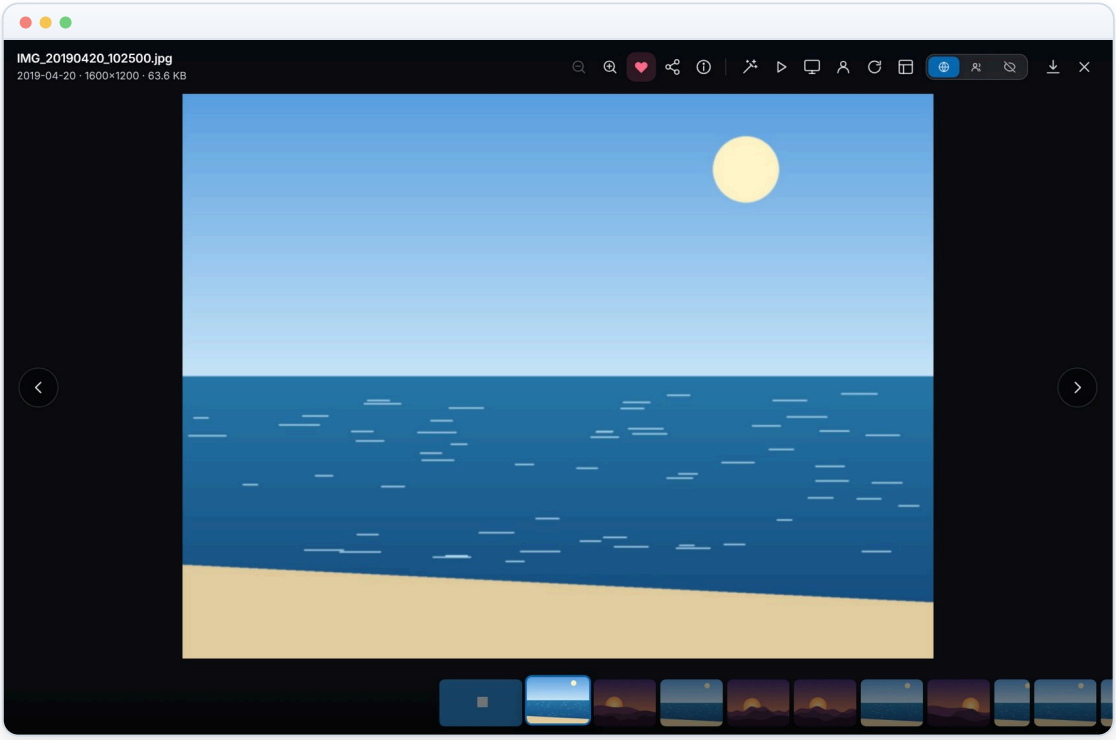


Figure 28 The viewer, with the filmstrip along the bottom.

Click a photo to open it full screen. Move with the arrows, the ← → keys, or by swiping; close with ✕ or Esc. The buttons along the top, from left to right (in a narrow window, the ones after ⓘ move behind the ⋮ menu):

Button	What it does
− / +	Zoom out and in.
♡	Add to your favourites (F).
Share	Make a share link for this photo.
ⓘ	Details: name, folder, date taken, size, dimensions, camera (I).
Wand (Edit with Sudar (AI))	Edit the photo in the Sudar studio (chapter 9).
▷	**Slideshow** (Space).
Screen	**Ambient frame**: a slow full-screen show for a wall or TV (K).
Person	**Use as my profile picture**.

↻	**Rotate** (R), for administrators, on photos and videos. A bar opens under the picture: **Rotate left** and **Rotate right** (Shift+R and R), **Flip horizontal** (H), **Flip vertical** (V) and **Reset to original**. Press **Save** (Enter) to keep it, or **Cancel** (Esc). The picture and its thumbnail, in the gallery, the family app and share links, then show the new way; a turned video plays turned, with its own play bar. Only Ninaivu Lite's own record changes; the file itself is never changed.
Album	**Add to album**.
Globe / people / crossed eye	Public, Family or Hidden: who may see this one photo (administrators).
⬇	Download the original (D).

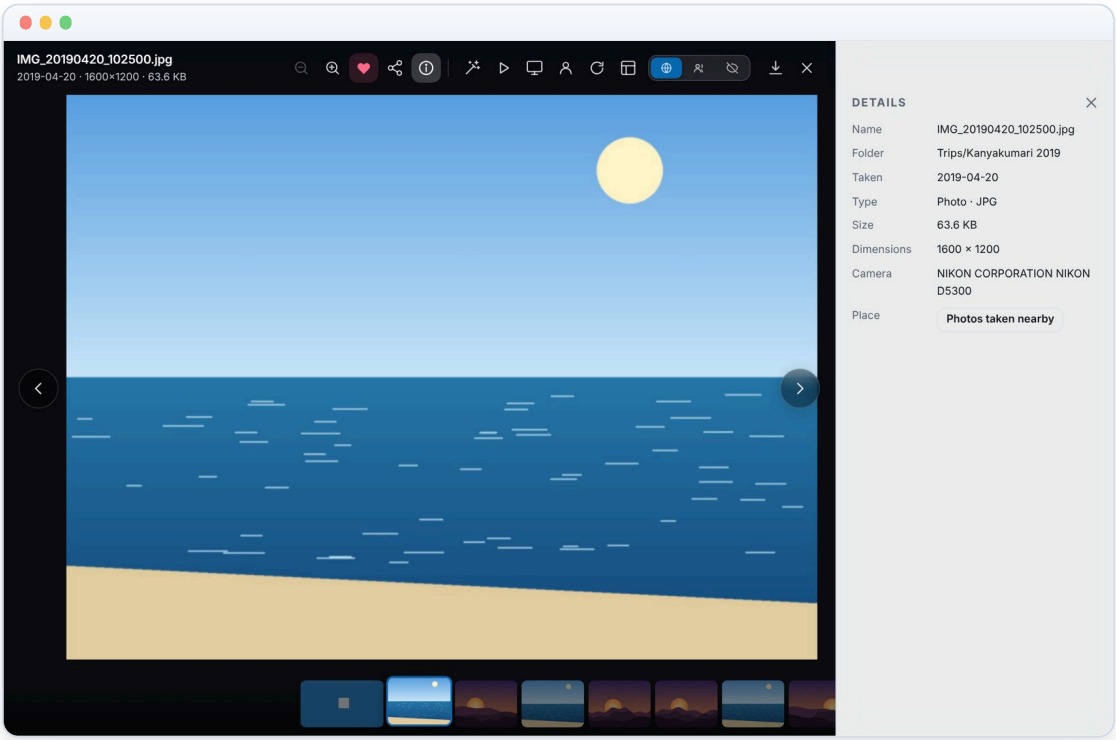


Figure 29 Details beside the photo.

Photos taken nearby. When a photo knows where it was taken, **Details** also has **Photos taken nearby**: the gallery then shows everything taken within about a kilometre of it, as a filter that × or **Clear all** removes. For the family and administrators only; guests are never shown places.

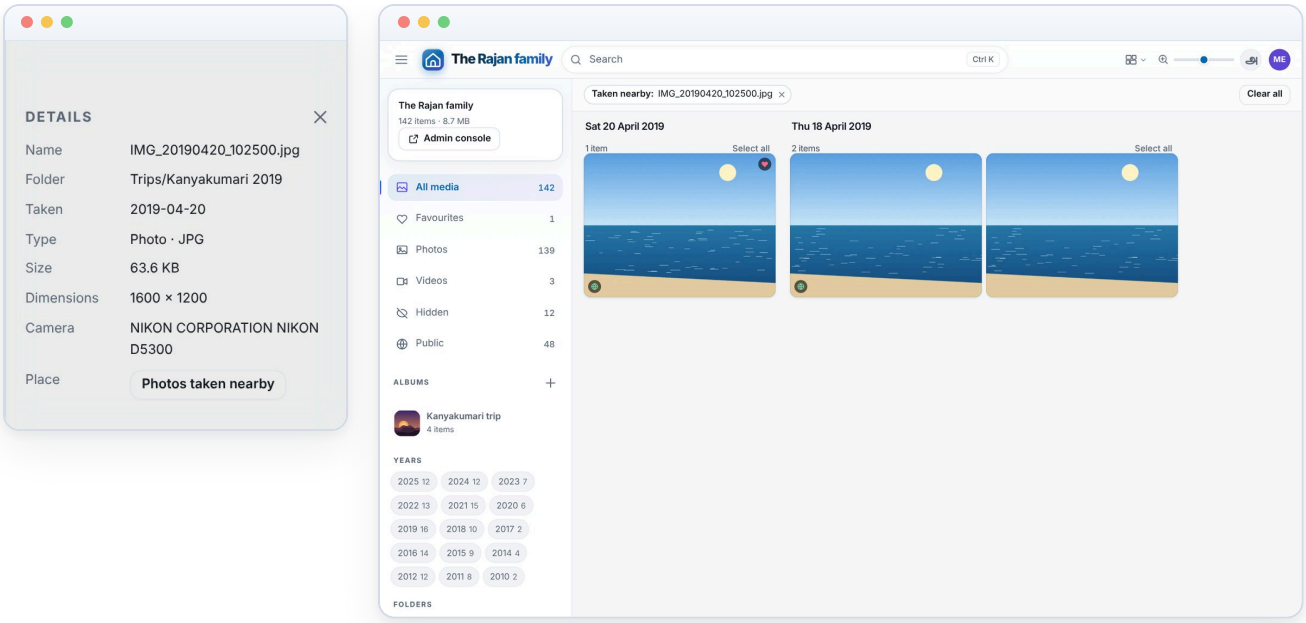


Figure 30 Photos taken nearby in Details, and the gallery showing what was taken around that place.

Live Photos. An iPhone keeps a Live Photo as two files side by side, `IMG_1234.HEIC` (or `.JPG`) and a short `IMG_1234.MOV`. Ninaivu Lite pairs them: the photo shows once, with a small ◎ mark on its tile, and the short video is not shown, counted or found on its own. In the viewer press **LIVE** at the top left to see it move once, or hold it to keep it moving; a share link plays it the same way, and a zip download of the photo carries its video. Both files stay where they are, untouched.

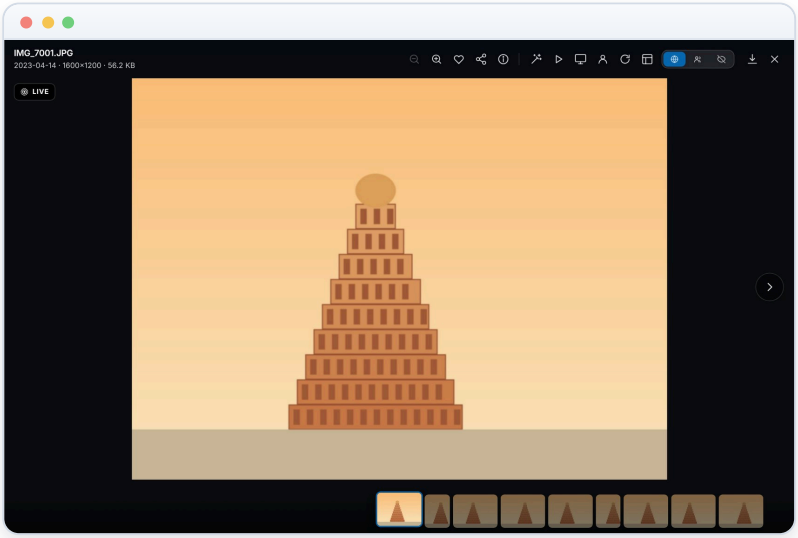


Figure 31 A Live Photo: press LIVE at the top left to see it move.

08 CHAPTER 8 Sharing with someone outside the family

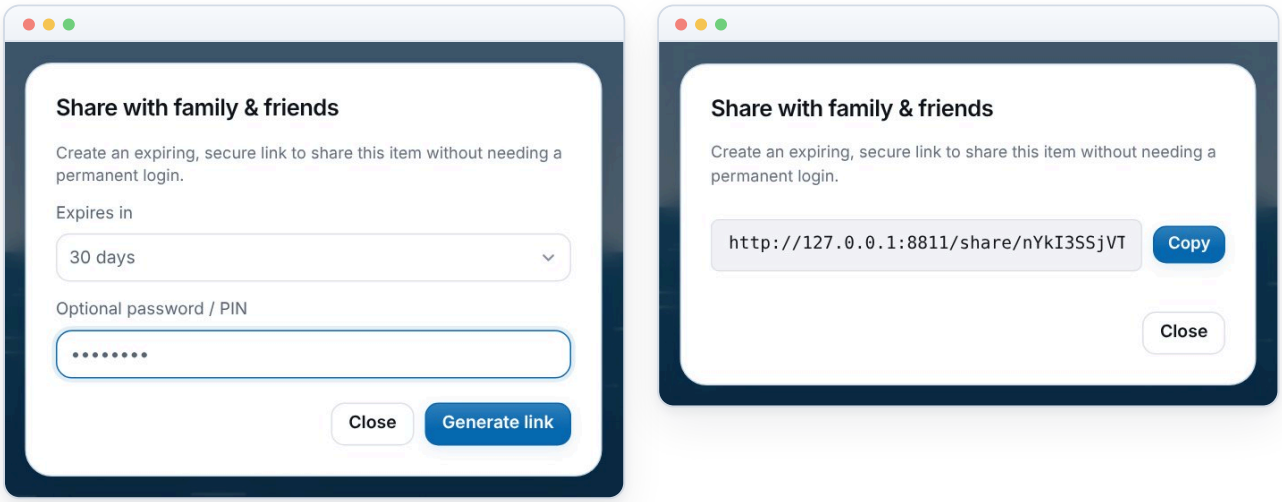


Figure 32 Choose an expiry and an optional password, then copy the link.

1. In the viewer press the share button (**Share link**), or **Share album** on an open album.
2. Choose when it expires: 7 days, 30 days or never. Add a password or PIN if you like; whoever has the link can try it 60 times a day at most.
3. Press **Generate link**, then **Copy**, and send the link to the person.
4. Your list of links is in your profile, where any link can be ended at any time.

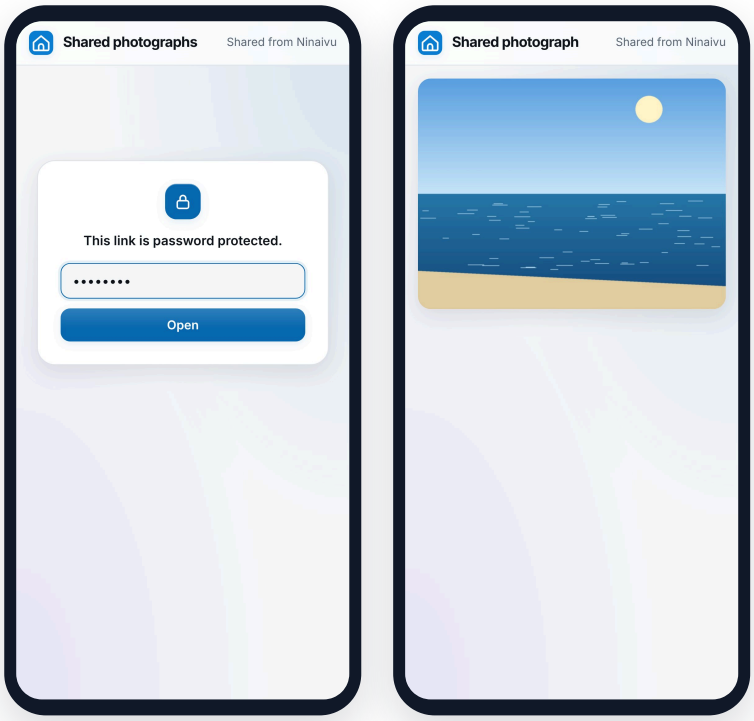


Figure 33 What the visitor sees: the password, then the photo.

Hidden photographs. A Hidden photograph cannot be shared: make it Family or Public first. A link to a photo stops working if the photo is later set to Hidden.

Videos. A video is sent with its location removed too, which needs ffmpeg on the computer. Without it, a guest or someone with a link is told the video cannot be shared, unless an administrator ticks **Send videos to guests and share links as they are when their location cannot be removed** in Settings; the video then keeps its location.

> **TIP**
> The visitor gets a copy without location or camera details, and does not see the file name. Links work only on your home network: Ninaivu Lite is not meant to be reached from the internet.

09 CHAPTER 9 Sudar, the photo studio

Sudar edits a photo in the browser. Nothing is sent anywhere and the original is never changed. Open it from the viewer: the wand button (**Edit with Sudar (AI)**), or on a phone ⋮ → **Edit with Sudar (AI)**.

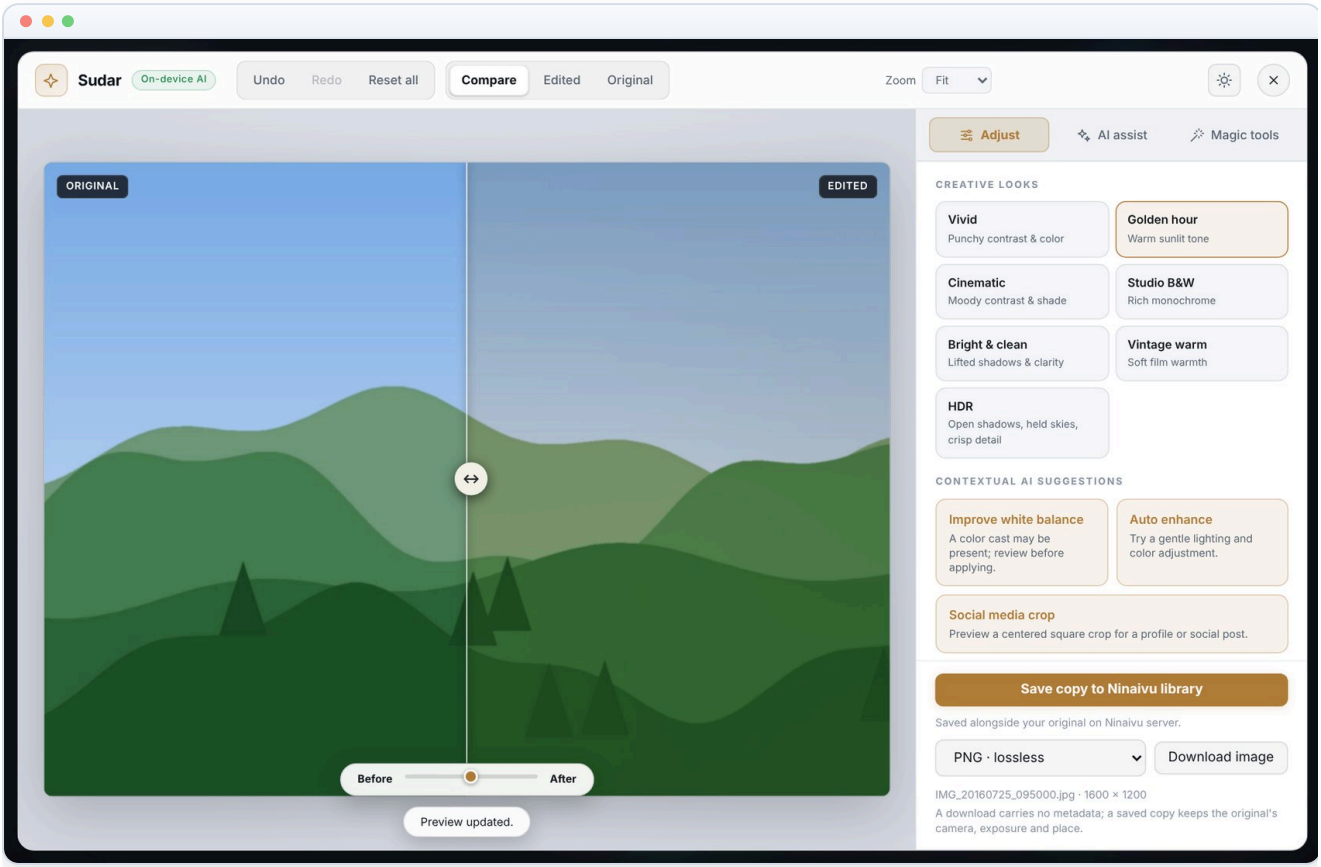


Figure 34 A look applied, compared before and after with the slider.

1. In **Adjust**, pick a look (**Vivid**, **Golden hour**, **Cinematic** and others), a suggestion, or move the sliders for light, colour and detail.
2. Drag the slider across the photo to compare the original and the edit.
3. In **AI assist**, describe the change in plain words, such as *make it warmer*, and press **Plan edits**. Review the plan before applying it.
4. When it looks right, press **Download image**, or as an administrator **Save copy to Ninaivu library** to keep a copy beside the original.

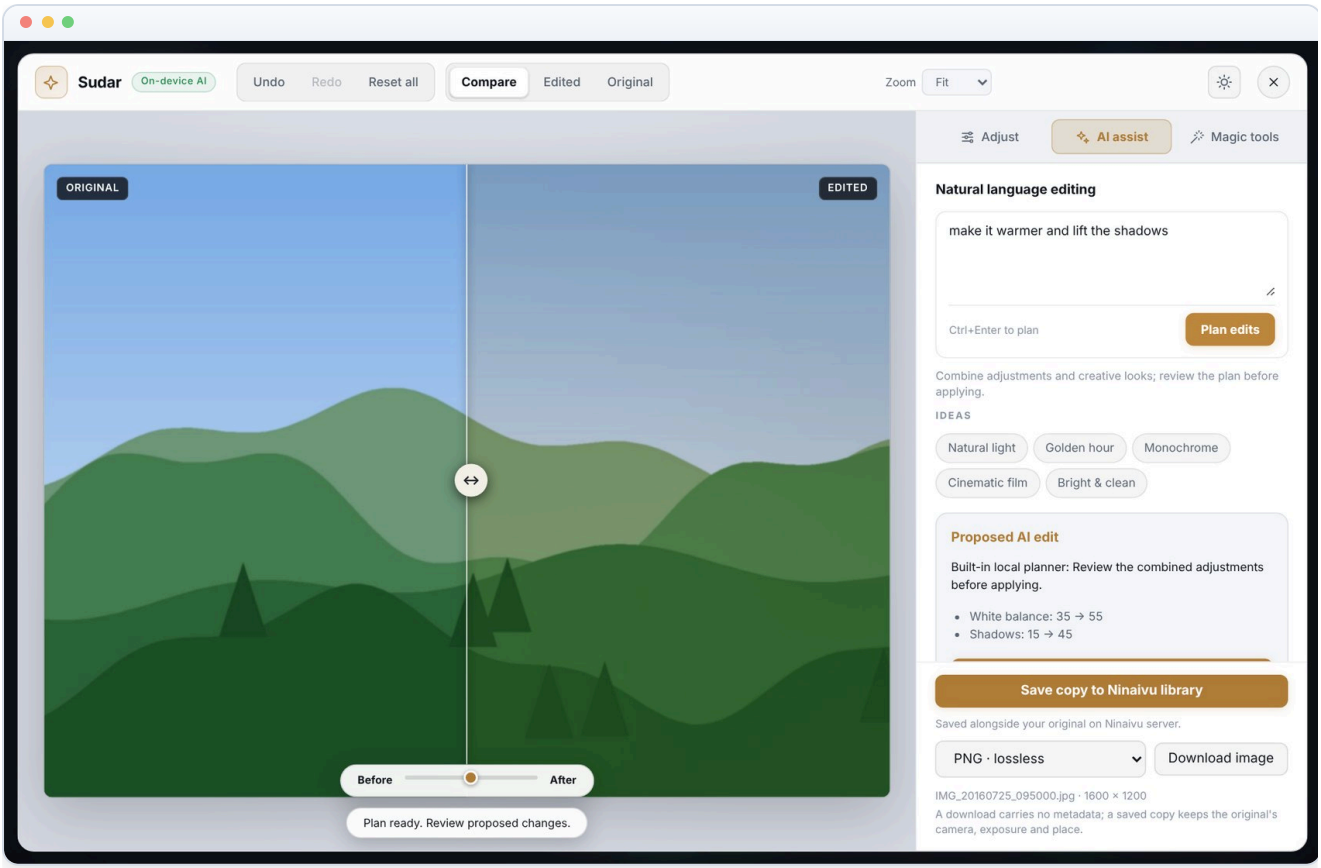


Figure 35 Asking for a change in plain words.

10 CHAPTER 10 Your profile and signing out

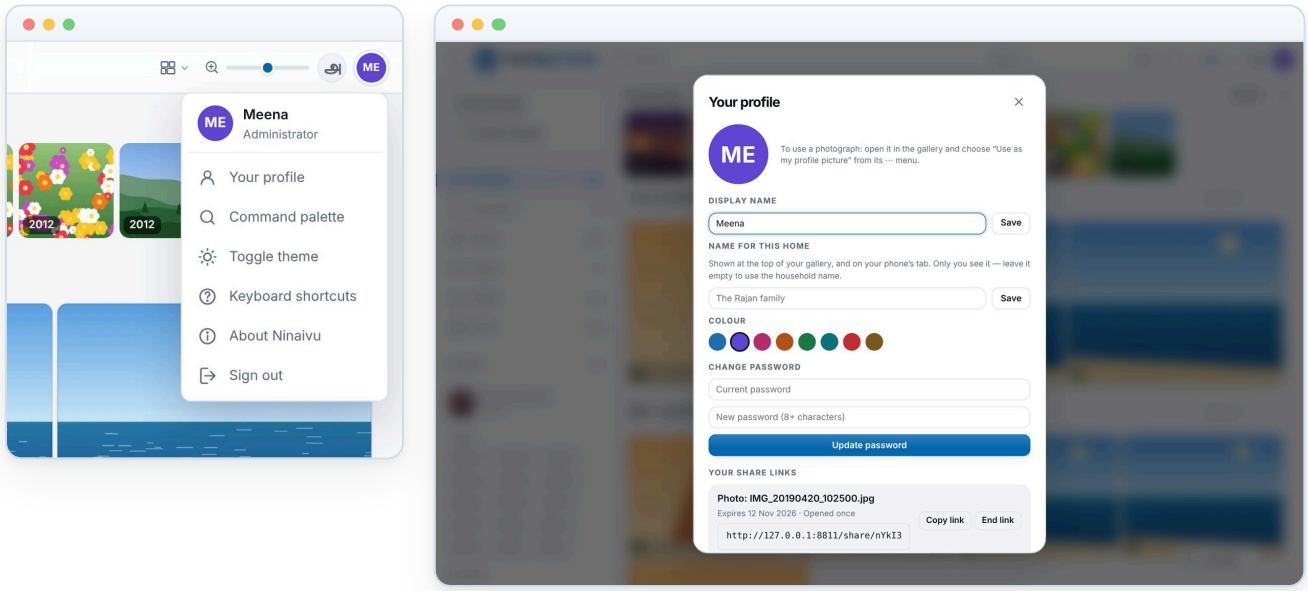


Figure 36 The profile menu, and Your profile.

- Press your initials at the top right. **Your profile** lets you change your name, colour and password, and lists your share links.
- **Your picture:** open a Family or Public photo, then choose **Use as my profile picture**. Remove picture in your profile puts the initials back; an administrator can remove anyone's from *People*. The picture is shown to whoever reaches the sign-in screen, so a Hidden photo cannot be used; choose one you are happy to show.
- **Sign out** (the door symbol) returns to the sign-in screen.

11 CHAPTER 11 On a phone or tablet

Open the *On your phone* address from the Control Panel, such as `http://192.168.1.20:8080/`, in the phone's browser. Add it to the home screen to open it like an app. The phone keeps Ninaivu Lite's own files until it is updated, so the gallery opens quickly on later visits; after an update it fetches the new ones by itself. Held sideways, the sign-in screens and dialogs scroll, so every button can be reached.

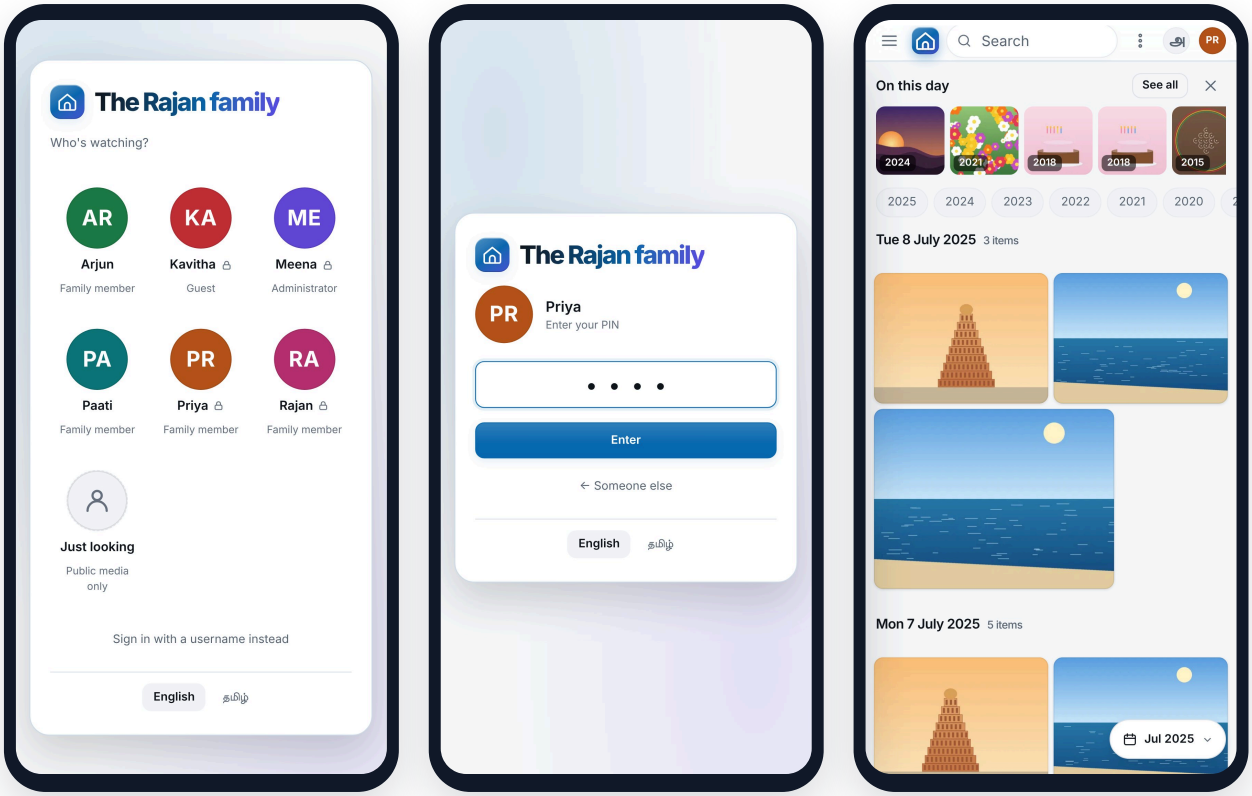


Figure 37 Pick your picture, enter your PIN, and the timeline opens.

1. Tap your own picture. A profile with no secret opens straight away.
2. If it asks for a PIN or password, type it and tap **Enter**. **← Someone else** goes back to the pictures.
3. On a tablet the family shares, signing in as someone else signs the previous person out of it, so nobody stays signed in as them.
4. **Just looking** shows only public photos, with no sign-in.
5. On a phone a row of years sits above the photos: tap one to jump to it. The date button in the bottom corner opens every year and month with photos, from the bottom of the screen. Tap ☰ for the menu with albums and folders.

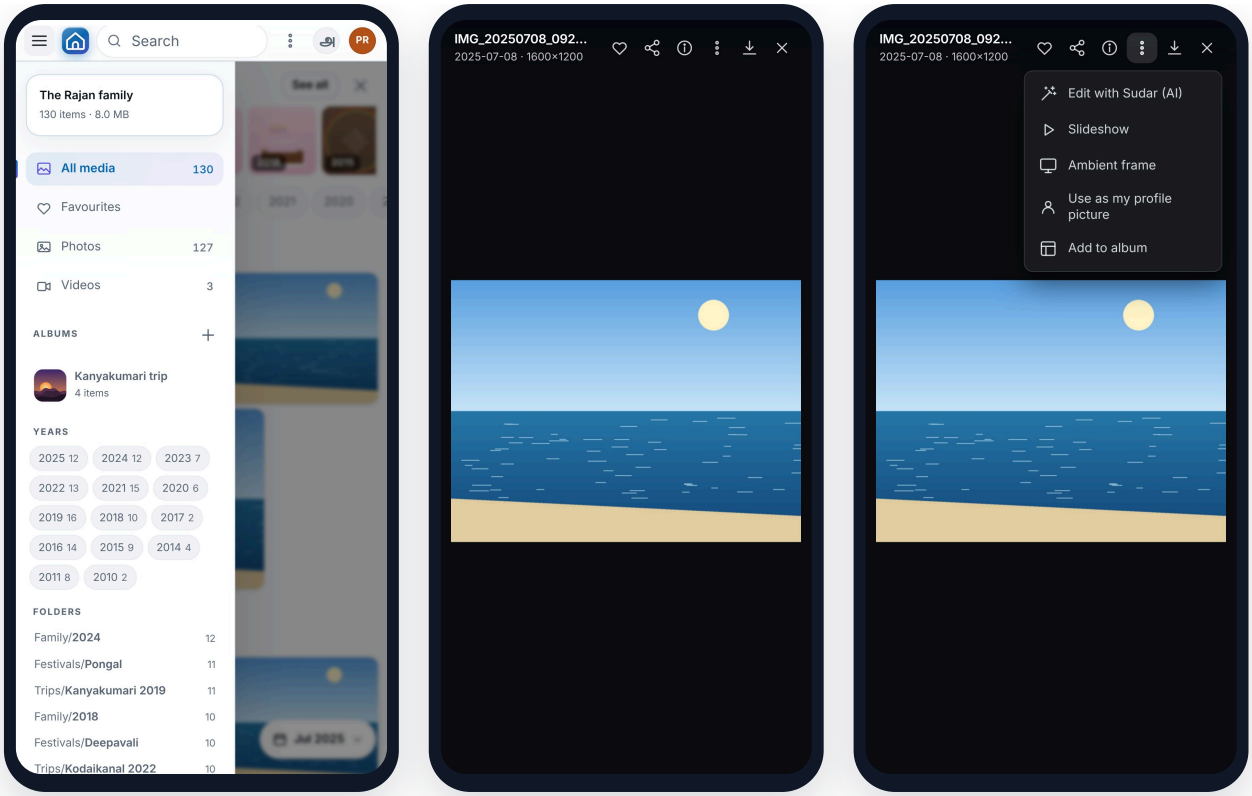


Figure 38 The menu, the viewer, and the viewer's ⋮ menu.

In the viewer, swipe left or right to move and down to close. The everyday buttons stay on the bar; the rest (**Edit with Sudar (AI)**, slideshow, ambient frame, profile picture, add to album) are behind ⋮. To select several photos, press and hold one, then tap others.

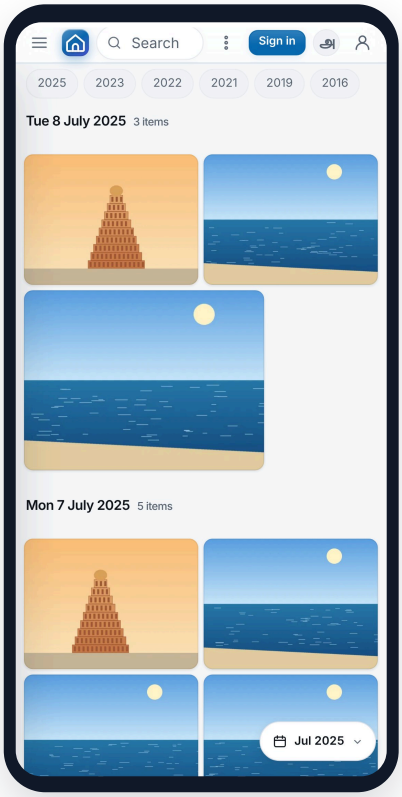


Figure 39 Just looking: a visitor sees only the folders made public.

12 CHAPTER 12 Looking after it

- **Backups:** every day Ninaivu Lite makes a full recovery zip (the index with people, albums, favourites, share links and visibility, the settings, and profile pictures) in `backups/` in its data folder, and keeps the last 7 days, plus one a week for 4 weeks and one a month for 3 months. It also takes one just before a library folder or a person is removed. *Settings* lists the copies kept, and says so if the last daily copy failed. *Settings → Download a backup* gives you one to keep elsewhere; keep it private, as it holds everyone's password and PIN checks and the share links. To put one back, stop Ninaivu Lite and run the command below for how it was installed, with `--restore <zip>` in place of `--reset-password <username>`; what was there is kept in a `before-restore-…` folder inside the data folder, never deleted. Everyone signs in again afterwards. If the restored folders are not where they were (a new computer), use **Moved?** on *Library settings*. Your photos are not in the zip: they are your own files, so back them up as you always do.
- **Data folder:** `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Ninaivu-lite` on Windows, `~/Library/Application Support/Ninaivu-lite` on a Mac, `~/.local/share/ninaivu-lite` on Linux; the `data` folder beside the program for the portable zip; `/var/lib/ninaivu-lite` for Linux installed with `sudo`; the `ninaivu_lite_data` volume for Docker. It holds settings, the index, previews, backups and logs, never your photos.
- **Who can reach it:** Ninaivu Lite answers phones and computers on your home network, a private VPN such as Tailscale, and the computer it runs on. A request from the internet (mobile data through a port forwarded on the router, or a tunnel such as ngrok or Cloudflare Tunnel) is refused with *Ninaivu Lite answers only the home network.* Only someone who puts HTTPS of their own in front of it should change this: stop Ninaivu Lite and set `"allow_internet": true` in `settings.json` in the data folder (or the environment variable `NINAIVU_ALLOW_INTERNET=1`; with Docker, `ALLOW_INTERNET=1`).
- **Forgot the admin password?** Stop Ninaivu Lite, then on that computer run the command for how it was installed:
  - **Windows installer, or Linux without `sudo`:** `ninaivu-lite --reset-password <username>` (on Windows, in a new Command Prompt).
  - **macOS app:** in Terminal, `"/Applications/Ninaivu Lite.app/Contents/MacOS/ninaivu-lite" --server --reset-password <username>`.
  - **Linux with `sudo`:** `sudo systemctl stop ninaivu-lite`, then `sudo -u ninaivu-lite /usr/local/bin/ninaivu-lite --reset-password <username>`, then `sudo systemctl start ninaivu-lite`.
  - **Portable zip:** in its `Ninaivu Lite` folder, `app\Python\python.exe -m ninaivu_lite --data "<that folder>\data" --reset-password <username>`.
  - **A copy of the source:** `python -m ninaivu_lite --reset-password <username>` (inside the folder, after `.venv\Scripts\activate` on Windows or `source .venv/bin/activate` elsewhere).
  - **Docker:** `docker compose -f installers/docker/docker-compose.yml run --rm ninaivu-lite python -m ninaivu_lite --data /data --reset-password <username>`.
- **A drive unplugged?** Its photos show as unavailable and come back when it returns. Nothing is lost.
- **Updating:** Ninaivu Lite never checks for a newer version and asks nothing of GitHub; download one from the releases page when you choose to. **First stop Ninaivu Lite**: in the Control Panel press **Stop** and close it; on a Linux server, `sudo systemctl stop ninaivu-lite`. If you forget, the Windows and

Linux installers offer to stop it and wait. Then, with an installer, run the new installer. On Linux, run the newer `.sh` the same way as the first. On a Mac, drag the new app over the old one in Applications; if Ninaivu Lite was still running, the Control Panel says so: press **Restart**. For the portable zip, press **Stop** and untick **Start Ninaivu Lite when I sign in** in the old copy's Control Panel, extract the new version to a new folder, copy the old `data` folder into it, and tick the box in the new copy's Control Panel. For a copy of the source, replace the program files and start it again. Your settings, people, index, backups and photos are untouched. The first start after an update brings the index forward by itself, after keeping a copy of it as it was (`backups/before-update-…zip`). The versions with *Flip* bring the index to version 10, which 1.11.1 and older cannot open (they say so and do not start): going back from one of them to 1.11.1 or older means installing the older version and restoring, with `--restore`, the copy the update kept, `backups/before-update-from-index-9-…zip` (see *Backups* above; what was changed since, a turn or a new album, is not in it). The versions with *Live Photos* and *Duplicates* bring the index to version 11, which 1.12.0 and older cannot open: going back to 1.12.0 means restoring `backups/before-update-from-index-10-…zip` the same way. Going back from 1.11.1 to 1.11.0, 1.10.0, 1.9.0, 1.8.0 or 1.7.0 needs nothing special. Going back to 1.6.0 or older means restoring a backup made before the update (see *Backups* above): version 1.6.0 cannot open the index of 1.7.0 or later.

- **Linux, installed with `sudo`:** Ninaivu Lite runs as a service under its own `ninaivu-lite` account, never as root, with its data in `/var/lib/ninaivu-lite`, and there is no Control Panel: use `sudo systemctl start|stop|restart ninaivu-lite`. That account must be able to read your photo folders and pass through every folder above them. The installer names any it cannot read; let it in with, for example:

```
sudo setfacl -R -m u:ninaivu-lite:rX /home/me/Pictures (what is there now)
sudo setfacl -R -d -m u:ninaivu-lite:rX /home/me/Pictures (what is added later)
sudo setfacl -m u:ninaivu-lite:x /home/me (each folder above it)
sudo systemctl restart ninaivu-lite
```

  It may not see drives your desktop opens; add their folders under *Import* yourself.
- **Moving up to Ninaivu (optional):** for faces, search by description or cloud backup, the full Ninaivu can take over your library. Use *Settings → Export for Ninaivu*, or run the command above with `--export lite-export.json`, and give that file to Ninaivu.

13 CHAPTER 13 Common questions

Question	Answer
The phone can't open the address.	Use the address shown in the Control Panel (not `localhost`), make sure the phone is on the same Wi-Fi, and allow Ninaivu Lite (Python) through the Windows firewall when asked. On Linux, let port 8080 through the firewall: `sudo ufw allow 8080/tcp` (Ubuntu, Raspberry Pi OS) or `sudo firewall-cmd --permanent --add-port=8080/tcp && sudo firewall-cmd --reload` (Fedora).
"This address is not one Ninaivu Lite answers to."	Ninaivu Lite answers only to this computer's own names: its addresses (such as `http://192.168.1.20:8080`), its network name (`mypc` or `mypc.local`) and `localhost`. To use another name (a name of your own, or a reverse proxy), stop Ninaivu Lite and add it to `"allowed_hosts"` in `settings.json` in the data folder, for example `"allowed_hosts": ["photos.home"]`, or to the `NINAIVU_ALLOWED_HOSTS` environment variable (names separated by commas; with Docker, `ALLOWED_HOSTS`), then start it again.
"Ninaivu Lite answers only the home network."	The phone or computer reached it from the internet, not from home: on mobile data through a port forwarded on the router, or through a tunnel. Connect it to the home Wi-Fi, or to a private VPN such as Tailscale, and use the address from the Control Panel. To allow the internet on purpose, see *Who can reach it* in chapter 12.
A guest or a share link says a video cannot be shared.	Install `ffmpeg` on the computer: Ninaivu Lite needs it to remove a video's location before sending it. Or, as the administrator, tick **Send videos to guests and share links as they are when their location cannot be removed** in Settings (the video then keeps its location).
Some videos show a plain tile.	A video gets its preview picture the first time a family member or administrator scrolls past it or plays it. A video the browser cannot play keeps the plain tile (install `ffmpeg` on the computer for those); it can still be downloaded.
iPhone HEIC photos show a plain tile.	Install the optional HEIC support (`pip install pillow-heif` in Ninaivu Lite's Python: `.venv\Scripts\pip` on Windows, `.venv/bin/pip` elsewhere), then restart.
Port 8080 is busy.	Ninaivu Lite uses the next free port and shows it in the Control Panel; or choose one with `--port`.
Someone forgot their PIN.	An administrator opens **People** in the console and uses **Reset password**, or changes how that person signs in.
Can people outside the house see the photos?	No. Ninaivu Lite answers only the home network and private VPNs, and refuses requests from the internet. Do not open it to the internet: it uses plain HTTP.

Ninaivu Lite 1.15.0

Your family's photographs, at home.

github.com/javajaga-usa/Ninaivu-lite

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